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Review preview status

This is a review preview, not a finished grammar. It is an assembled draft of the current Tedim grammar sections. Several domains remain incomplete, and end-of-section caveats remain visible while the draft is still under review.

Abbreviations

Standard Leipzig Glossing Abbreviations

1	first person	IMP	imperative
2	second person	INCL	inclusive
3	third person	INS	instrumental
ABIL	abilitative	INTENS	intensive
ABL	ablative	IRR	irrealis
ALL	allative	ITER	iterative
APPL	applicative	LOC	locative
CAUS	causative	NEG	negative
COM	comitative	NMLZ	nominalizer
COMPL	completive	PFV	perfective
CONT	continuative	PL	plural
CVB	converb	POSS	possessive
DAT	dative	PROSP	prospective
DIMIN	diminutive	PROX	proximal
ERG	ergative	Q	question particle
EXCL	exclusive	RECIP	reciprocal
EXP	experiential	REFL	reflexive
GEN	genitive	REL	relativizer
HAB	habitual	RES	resultative
HORIZ	horizontal	SG	singular
IMM	immediate	TOP	topic

Tedim Chin-Specific Conventions

1SG→3	first singular acting on third person
2→1	second person acting on first person
3→1	third person acting on first person
AG	agent (nominalizer)
AUG	augmentative (big/great)
DIST	distal/anaphoric demonstrative
DOWN	downward directional
HAB.CONT	habitual continuative
I	verb form I (citation form)
II	verb form II (dependent form)
MORE	comparative (more X)
NEG.ABIL	negative abilitative (cannot)
PROX	proximal demonstrative
TOWARD	goal directional
UP	upward directional

Verb Forms: Tedim Chin verbs have two conjugation forms. I (Form I) is the citation/independent form; II (Form II) appears in dependent clauses and certain constructions.

1 Phonology and tone

A full discussion of phonology and tone is not yet included in this review preview.

2 Deixis, pronouns, and nominal domain

2.1 Demonstratives / deixis

2.1.1 Overview of the demonstrative system

The current Bible corpus and the literature agree on a compact demonstrative core: proximal *hih* and distal *tua* (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). In Bible usage, however, *tua* is not merely a spatial “that”. It is also a strongly anaphoric and discourse-linking form, especially in narrative and temporal sequencing. The most economical description is therefore a system with *hih* as the core proximal demonstrative and *tua* as the core distal/anaphoric demonstrative.

The plural forms *hihte* and *tuat* behave transparently as DEM + *-te*, and the Bible also gives strong constructional material such as *hih bangin*, *tua bangin*, *tua ciangin*, and *tua ahih ciangin*. One caution remains explicit throughout this slice: Zam Ngaih Cing gives distal *huā*, while the Bible corpus overwhelmingly uses *tua* as the ordinary distal/anaphoric form (Cing, 2017). The relation is plausible, but it is not resolved here as a settled orthographic identity.

2.1.2 Core demonstratives: *hih* and *tua*

Hih is the clearest proximal form in the present corpus. It works both as an identificational demonstrative and as an adnominal determiner.

- (2.1) *Hih pèn Adam’ suanlekhakte’ laibu àhì hì.*
PROX TOP ADAM.POSS genealogy-PL.POSS book be.3SG DECL
‘This is the book of the generations of Adam.’ (Genesis 5:1)

Genesis 5:1 is especially useful because it shows *hih* as the unmarked proximal form in identificational prose. Genesis 9:12 *Hih pen... thuciamna lim ahi hi* confirms the same pattern, while Exodus 32:9 *Hih mite ka mu zo hi* shows *hih* before a noun phrase in ordinary adnominal use.

Tua belongs to the same system, but its range in the Bible is broader. It clearly marks distal or previously activated referents, and it also extends naturally into anaphoric and discourse-linking uses.

- (2.2) *Pasian in, tuite’ lai-zang-àh vàn kuum-pì òm hèn lá, túa vàn kuum-pì*
God ERG water-PL.POSS middle-side-LOC sky bow-big exist JUSS take DIST sky bow-big
in tui lè tui kī-khen-sàk hèn” cí hì.
ERG water and water REFL-divide-CAUS JUSS say DECL
‘And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.’ (Genesis 1:6)

Genesis 1:6 is a clean adnominal example. Genesis 21:27 *tua mi nihte* is equally good for a more discourse-linked noun phrase. The important descriptive point is that the corpus keeps using *tua* where English may translate “that”, “the same”, or simply a contextually given referent.

2.1.3 Plural forms: *hihte* and *tuat*

The plural demonstratives are straightforward. The Bible corpus strongly supports *hihte* and *tuat* as transparent plural extensions of the singular forms.

- (2.3) *Israel in Josef’ tapa-tè à mùh ciang-in àmàh in, hih-tè kua àhì hiam”*
ISRAEL ERG JOSEF.POSS son-PL 3SG see.II then-ERG 3SG.PRO ERG HIHTE who be.3SG Q
à cí hì.
3SG say DECL
‘And Israel beheld Joseph’s sons, and said, Who are these?’ (Genesis 48:8)

- (2.4) *Mual lian-tè tòngàh tùi om-tò lái à, túa-tè tòngàh pì sàwm-nìh*
 mountain big-PL on-LOC water be-over midst 3SG DIST-PL on-LOC grandmother ten-two
lè nìh thuk-in tuumcip hì.
 and two deep-INST water DECL

‘Fifteen cubits upward did the waters prevail; and the mountains were covered.’ (Genesis 7:20)

Genesis 10:20 *Hihte pen... Ham’ suanlekhakte ahi hi* shows the proximal plural in topic-like prose, while Genesis 2:19 *mipa in tuate bang a ci hiam* shows the distal plural as an ordinary pronoun. Nothing in the present corpus suggests that these need any more complex treatment than DEM + *-te*.

2.1.4 Adnominal and pronominal uses

The same forms serve both as adnominal modifiers and as independent pronouns. Adnominal use is easy to see in Exodus 32:9 *Hih mite*, Genesis 1:6 *tua van kuumpi*, and Genesis 21:27 *tua mi nihte*. Pronominal use is equally clear in Genesis 5:1 *Hih pen*, Genesis 48:8 *Hihte kua ahi hiam?*, and Genesis 2:19 *tuat bang a ci hiam*.

The Bible also shows productive matter/topic phrases such as *hih thu* and *tua thu*. In Genesis 24:9 *hih thu tawh kisai-in* points to the present matter under discussion, while Genesis 6:6 *tua thu in ama lungsim dahsak hi* and Exodus 2:15 *Faro in tua thu a zak ciangin* show anaphoric reference to something just reported. These are important for the grammar chapter, even if they do not have to be first-round dictionary headwords.

2.1.5 Discourse and temporal deixis

This is where *tua* most clearly exceeds a merely spatial description. In Bible narrative, *tua* is a major discourse and temporal linker.

- (2.5) *Pasian in, khuavak òm hèn” cí hì; túa ciang-in khuavak òm pah hì.*
 God ERG light exist JUSS say DECL DIST then-ERG light exist do.so DECL
 ‘And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.’ (Genesis 1:3)

Tua ciangin works naturally as “then / at that time” in event sequencing. Genesis 5:5 repeats the same pattern in obituary-style narrative: *tua ciangin amah si hì*.

Tua ahih ciangin is even more explicitly a discourse bridge, linking a prior state or event to the next clause.

- (2.6) *Túa àhìh ciang-in Topa Pasian in mipa ihmut sùak màhmàh sàk à,*
 DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG Lord God ERG man deep.sleep wither very CAUS 3SG
àmà ihmut kal-in à nak-gùh-tè khàt lá-in túa mùn pèn sá-tak
 3SG.POSS deep.sleep middle-CVB 3SG nose-bone-PL one take-ERG DIST place TOP flesh-piece
tàwh à dimsak hì.
 COM 3SG fill DECL
 ‘And the LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall upon Adam, and he slept: and he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh instead thereof.’ (Genesis 2:21)

Genesis 1:21 and Genesis 2:19 confirm that *tua ahih ciangin* is one of the strongest discourse-transition frames in the present corpus. It is better understood as a fixed demonstrative-temporal construction than as a purely compositional spatial phrase.

2.1.6 Manner constructions with *bangin*

The Bible also gives strong manner and discourse constructions built from the demonstratives plus *bangin*.

(2.7) *àmaute hìlh-in, nòtè in kà topa Esau kiang-àh hìh bàng-in nà cí dǐng*
 3PL.PRO teach-CVB 2PL.PRO ERG 1SG lord ESAU beside-LOC PROX like-ERG 2SG say IRR
ùh hì: Nà nàsèm-pà Jakob in, laban' kiang-àh peem-tà-in tù
 2/3PL DECL 2SG servant-male JAKOB ERG LABAN.POSS beside-LOC widow.son-PFV-ERG now
ciàng dòng kà òm hì.
 then until 1SG exist DECL

‘And he commanded them, saying, Thus shall ye speak unto my lord Esau; Thy servant Jacob saith thus, I have sojourned with Laban, and stayed there until now.’ (Genesis 32:4)

(2.8) *Topa in túa bàng-in Egypt mite' khutsung pàn-in túa nì-in Israel-té*
 Lord ERG DIST like-ERG EGYPT person-PL.POSS palm ABL-ERG DIST day-ERG ISRAEL-TE
honkhia à, tùi-pì gei-àh Egypt mì à sí-tè, Israel mì-tè in mú
 deliver 3SG water-big edge-LOC EGYPT person 3SG die-PL ISRAEL person-PL ERG see.I
ùh hì.
 2/3PL DECL

‘Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore.’ (Exodus 14:30)

Hih bangin is especially good for direct instruction or quoted manner, as also seen in Genesis 42:18 *hih bangin gamta un. Tua bangin* often resumes or summarizes an already described event, as in Genesis 50:21 *Amah in tua bangin... amaute a hehnem hi*. These patterns belong naturally in a demonstratives slice because the deictic base still contributes to how the construction organizes discourse.

2.1.7 Deferred forms: *hi* and *hih ciangin*

Hi should be deferred. Exact-token *hi* is far too entangled with copular, auxiliary, and sentence-final material to serve as a safe demonstrative headword in this section. Genesis 48:18 *Hi lo hi, pa aw; hih pen a suak masa ahi hi* shows how quickly the shorter form is absorbed into other clause types. The right place for *hi* is later work on copula or sentence-final particles, not this first demonstratives section.

Hih ciangin should also be deferred. The current background notes showed that many apparent hits involve verbal *hih* “do/be thus” rather than demonstrative *hih*. Genesis 18:10, the old generated-report example, does not contain exact demonstrative *hih ciangin*. For the present slice, *tua ciangin* is strong enough to represent the temporal side of the system on its own.

2.1.8 Editorial summary

The current evidence supports a compact but stable demonstrative system. *Hih* is the core proximal demonstrative. *Tua* is the core distal/anaphoric demonstrative and should not be reduced to a merely spatial “that”. *Hihte* and *tuatè* are transparent plural forms, and the constructional extensions *hih bangin*, *tua bangin*, *tua ciangin*, and *tua ahih ciangin* are all well supported by manually checked Bible examples.

Just as important, the chapter has to preserve its cautions. *Hi* is not yet safe as a demonstrative headword, *hih ciangin* is not yet a stable temporal counterpart to *tua ciangin*, and the relation between Bible *tua* and the literature’s *huā* is plausible but unresolved. With those limits kept explicit, demonstratives and deixis make a good narrow chapter for the next Tedim section.

2.2 Pronouns / clusivity

2.2.1 Personal pronouns

Earlier descriptions agree on a basic personal-pronoun system with distinct first, second, and third persons and with plural forms for at least the first and second persons (Henderson, 1965, 32-33; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.1). Henderson explicitly lists *kei*, *nang*, *amah*, *ei/eite*, *ko/kote*, and *no/note*, while Zam Ngaih Cing confirms the broader person-and-number system and the absence of gender in the third person (Henderson, 1965, 32; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.1). For present purposes, the following paradigm is stable enough to use:

Person	Singular	Plural
1	<i>kei</i>	<i>eite, kote</i>
2	<i>nang</i>	<i>note</i>
3	<i>amah</i>	<i>amaute</i>

- (2.9) *Mipa in à zi' mīn pèn Eve, cí hì. Bàng hàng hiam cih lèh àmah*
 man ERG 3SG wife.POSS name TOP EVE say DECL like reason Q say.NOM and 3SG.PRO
pèn mì-hìng khèmpèuh' nù àhì hì.
 TOP person-kind all.POSS female be.3SG DECL
 ‘And Adam called his wife’s name Eve; because she was the mother of all living.’ (Genesis 3:20)

- (2.10) *Ēn ùn, nòtè lè nòtè' khìt à nà suanlekhak-tè ùh lè,*
 look IMP.PL 2PL.PRO and 2PL.PRO.POSS SEQ 3SG 2SG genealogy-PL 2/3PL and
 ‘And I, behold, I establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you;’ (Genesis 9:9)

These examples are ordinary independent pronouns rather than bound agreement markers. *amah* functions as a free third-person form, while *note* shows the equally straightforward second-person plural. The printed chapter can therefore begin from free pronouns and only then move to the more tightly bound prefixal system.

2.2.2 First-person plural forms and clusivity

The main editorial problem in this slice is not whether Tedim has clusivity, but how far the current evidence supports global labels for the two first-person plural series. Henderson clearly distinguishes *ei/eite* from *ko/kote* through pronominal-concord prefixes, pairing the former with *i-* and the latter with *ka-* (Henderson, 1965, 32-33). Zam Ngaih Cing likewise treats clusivity as a real feature of Tedim person marking, even though her presentation of the plural forms is not identical in surface detail (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.1; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.2). The separate clusivity background notes for this slice shows that sampled Bible dialogue contexts strongly support *ko/kote* as exclusive, but that *ei/eite* has both clear inclusive uses and less straightforward uses in the current Bible evidence. Comparative Sukte is useful here mainly as a contrast, since Singh does not describe the same inclusive/exclusive opposition for Sukte (Singh, 2018, sec. 4.6.1).

- (2.11) *Túa ciang-in Abram in Lot' kiang-àh, nàng lè kèi' kī-kal,*
 DIST then-ERG ABRAM ERG LOT.POSS beside-LOC 2SG.PRO and NEG.EMPH.POSS REFL-middle
nàng' gán-cíng-tè lè kèi' gán-cíng-te' kī-kal-àh
 2SG.PRO.POSS cattle-care-PL and NEG.EMPH.POSS cattle-care-PL.POSS REFL-middle-LOC
kī-tot-ná òm-sàk kèi nì. Bàng hàng hiam cih lèh eite beh khàt
 REFL-cut-NMLZ exist-CAUS NEG day like reason Q say.NOM and 1PL.PRO tribe one
ì-hí hì"
 1PL.INCL-be DECL
 ‘And Abram said unto Lot, Let there be no strife, I pray thee, between me and thee, and between my herdmen and thy herdmen; for we be brethren.’ (Genesis 13:8)

- (2.12) *Kòtè tàwh kī-ten-ná hòng bāwl ùn. Nà tanu-tè ùh kòtè'*
 1PL.PRO COM REFL-marry-NMLZ 3→1 make IMP.PL 2SG daughter-PL 2/3PL 1PL.PRO.POSS
tùngàh hòng píá ùn-lá, no à dīng-in kà tanu-tè ùh lá ùn.
 on-LOC 3→1 give PL.IMP-and young 3SG IRR-ERG 1SG daughter-PL 2/3PL take IMP.PL
 ‘And make ye marriages with us, and give your daughters unto us, and take our daughters unto you.’ (Genesis 34:9)

Genesis 13:8 shows a genuinely inclusive use of *eite*, since Abram explicitly includes Lot in the relevant group. It does not prove that every *eite* token is inclusive. Genesis 34:9, by contrast, is a strong diagnostic for exclusive

kote, since Hamor addresses Jacob’s family from a distinct in-group. The present slice therefore treats *kote* as exclusive and leaves the exact global status of *eite* under review.¹

2.2.3 Possessive prefixes

The same person-marking forms that appear in pronominal concord also appear before nouns as possessive prefixes. Henderson treats *ka-*, *na-*, *a-*, and *i-* primarily as pronominal concord prefixes, while Zam Ngaih Cing foregrounds their possessive use in noun phrases (Henderson, 1965, 32-33; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.2; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.4.1.1). For a printed grammar, the safest description is that the forms are shared across possessive and agreement environments, but are easiest to present first in their nominal use.

- (2.13) *Kua’ tá-nù nà hì hiam, hòng gēn ìn. Nà pa’ inn-àh*
 who.POSS child-female 2SG DECL Q 3→1 speak ERG 2SG male.POSS house-LOC
kòtè’ giah nàdìng à áwng dīng hiam? à cí hì.
 1PL.PRO.POSS camp PURP 3SG open IRR Q 3SG say DECL
 ‘Whose daughter art thou? tell me, I pray thee: is there room in thy father’s house for us to lodge in?’
 (Genesis 24:23)

- (2.14) *Mipa ìn à zì’ mīn pèn Eve, cí hì.*
 man ERG 3SG wife.POSS name TOP EVE say DECL
 ‘And the man called his wife’s name Eve.’ (Genesis 3:20)

The same pattern is visible in *ka pa’ inn* ‘my father’s house’ and in the *i-* prefix that Henderson associates with the *ei/eite* series (Henderson, 1965, 32-33). Singh’s Sakte comparison is also helpful here, since it shows cognate person-marking prefixes in possessive use even though the wider systems are not identical (Singh, 2018, sec. 4.5.4). Plural verbal markers such as *-uh* belong to the later agreement chapter rather than to the pronoun inventory itself.

2.2.4 Emphatic pronouns in *-mah*

Emphatic pronouns are formed by adding *-mah* to a personal-pronoun base (Henderson, 1965, 32; Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.6). In print, it is best to treat these forms neither as an unrelated lexical series nor as mere stylistic variants, but as a productive emphatic pattern built on the ordinary pronoun paradigm.

- (2.15) *Kain ìn Topa’ tūngàh, Kèimah gīm hòng kī-piàk-ná, kà thùak zàwh*
 KAIN ERG Lord.POSS on-LOC 1SG.PRO suffering 3→1 REFL-give.to-NMLZ 1SG suffer able
dīng hì lò hì.
 IRR DECL NEG DECL
 ‘And Cain said unto the LORD, My punishment is greater than I can bear.’ (Genesis 4:13)
- (2.16) *Abimelek ìn, Ēn ìn, kà léi-tāng, nà mái-àh ōm hì. Nangmah ìn hòih nà*
 ABIMELEK ERG look ERG 1SG land-earth 2SG face-LOC exist DECL 2SG.PRO ERG good 2SG
sàk-ná mūn-àh tēng ìn, à cí hì.
 cause-NMLZ place-LOC remain ERG 3SG say DECL
 ‘And Abimelech said, Behold, my land is before thee: dwell where it pleaseth thee.’ (Genesis 20:15)

The same element also appears in negative-indefinite forms such as *kuamah* ‘no one’ and *bangmah* ‘nothing’ (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.7). Those items belong more naturally to a later section on indefinites and interrogative-based forms, but the connection should already be noted here.

¹The earlier report-level reversal *kote* inclusive versus *eite* exclusive has now been removed. The safer editorial position is narrower: *ko/kote* can already be treated as exclusive, but *ei/eite* still shows mixed Bible-corpus behavior and should remain under review rather than receiving a single global label.

2.2.5 Reflexive and reciprocal marking with *ki-*

Zam Ngaih Cing describes reflexive pronouns as repeated pronouns linked by *leh* (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.2.5). The biblical corpus nevertheless makes it clear that a print grammar also needs to acknowledge verbal *ki-*, since many reader-facing examples of reflexive or reciprocal meaning are expressed through *ki-* forms rather than through a free reflexive pronoun alone.

- (2.17) *Túa thù hàng-ìn pasal in à nù lè à pà nusia-ìn à zi*
 DIST word because-ERG husband ERG 3SG female and 3SG father abandon-ERG 3SG wife
tàwh kī-gawm à, àmau tegel pum khàt à bàng ùh hì.
 COM REFL-seize 3SG 3PL.PRO both body one 3SG like 2/3PL DECL
 ‘Therefore shall a man leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh.’ (Genesis 2:24)

For present purposes, *ki-* can already be described as a productive reflexive or reciprocal verbal prefix. The remaining caution is lexical rather than structural: some surface *ki-* forms are lexicalized stems, so not every *ki-* word should be taken automatically as transparent reflexive morphology.

2.2.6 Pronominal prefixes and inverse/directional marking

Henderson’s discussion of pronominal concord is still the best starting point for the bound prefix system. She pairs *kei* with *ka-*, *nang* with *na-*, the *ei/eite* series with *i-*, the *ko/kote* series with *ka-*, *no/note* with *na-*, and all other nominals with *a-* (Henderson, 1965, 32-33). Zam Ngaih Cing’s discussion of nominal prefixes confirms the same basic person-marking inventory in noun phrases (Cing, 2017, sec. 3.3.4.1.1). A printed chapter on pronouns does not need the whole verbal paradigm yet, but it does need to note that the independent pronouns belong to a wider system of bound person marking.

The harder question concerns *hong-* and *kong-*. The literature treats them as participant-oriented preverbal prefixes with directional or inverse-like behavior, and Otsuka’s causative discussion shows that first- and second-person objects are structurally important to their distribution (Cing, 2017, sec. 5.8.1.3; Otsuka, 2009). The current corpus outputs, however, do not yet yield a stable automatic example set for *hong-*, so the present slice uses only narrow, manually checked illustrations.²

- (2.18) *Àmàh in à sàng-ná pàn-ìn à khùt tàwh zā-mīn kèi hòng lá à,*
 3SG.PRO ERG 3SG high-NMLZ ABL-ERG 3SG hand COM hundred-thousand NEG 3→1 take 3SG
tùì thuk-pì pàn-ìn kèimàh hòng kà-ì-khà hì.
 water deep-big ABL-ERG 1SG.PRO 3→1 1SG-go-exit DECL
 ‘He sent from above, he took me, He drew me out of many waters.’ (Psalms 18:16)

- (2.19) *Faro in Josef’ kiang-àh, Egypt gàm khèmpèuh à ùk dīng-ìn nàng kòng*
 FARO ERG JOSEF.POSS beside-LOC EGYPT land all 3SG rule IRR-ERG 2SG.PRO 1SG→3
kòih khin-zò hì, à cí hì.
 put COMPL-COMPL DECL 3SG say DECL
 ‘And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.’ (Genesis 41:41)

These examples are enough to justify a cautious print description: *hong-* and *kong-* belong with person-sensitive preverbal marking, but the exact boundary between inverse, venitive, benefactive, and wider directional readings still needs fuller chapter-level review. They should therefore appear in the dictionary slice and grammar prose, but under an explicitly provisional analysis rather than as a closed paradigm.

²The present editorial problem is not whether these forms exist, but how narrowly they should be defined in a first print chapter. The current wording stays close to cases that can be read directly from the verse context without relying on a fully solved backend analysis.

2.2.7 Editorial summary

This slice now supports a real draft chapter on pronouns and pronominal marking. Independent pronouns, emphatic forms in *-mah*, and possessive prefixes are straightforward enough for print. *ki-* is also clear enough to present as reflexive or reciprocal verbal marking, provided lexicalized forms remain a review checkpoint. The main unresolved issue is not the existence of clusivity or of *hong-/kong-*, but how far the current report layer can be trusted to label those patterns automatically without closer editorial control.

2.2.8 References

2.3 NP structure / possession

The current evidence supports demonstrative-before-noun order alongside noun-plus-postnominal numeral and quantifier patterns, with possession kept as a cautious boundary subsection.

2.3.1 Overview of noun phrase structure

The clearest current evidence supports a small but coherent set of NP-order observations. Demonstrative-related material is safest where a proximal form precedes the noun, as in *hih mite* ‘these people’, with *hih* ‘this’ introducing the phrase. Numerals and several quantifier-like forms follow the noun in the cleanest current examples, as seen in *mi khat* ‘one person / a person’, *ni li* ‘four days’, *mi khempeuh* ‘all people’, *mi pawlkhat* ‘some people’, and *mi tampi* ‘many people’. The present section therefore supports a modest contrast between demonstrative-before-noun structure and noun-plus-postnominal numeral or quantifier structure, while leaving broader NP templating for later review.

Possession is now visible enough to include as part of the same section, but it remains less normalized than the modifier-order material. The safest checked rows show possessor-before-possessioned structure in compact noun phrases such as *na pa’ inn-ah* ‘in your father’s house’ and *a zi’ min* ‘his wife’s name’, while the analysis of possessive prefixes, apostrophe marking, genitive structure, and relator or case overlap still requires explicit caveats.

Gospel searches produced clean noun-plus-numeral and noun-plus-quantifier examples, which helps keep the section from becoming Genesis-only. Demonstratives and possession remain more OT-led in the current stage because the Gospel comparanda were less clean under present careful evidence control.

2.3.2 Current NP pattern inventory

Pattern	Example form	Rough function	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
demonstrative + noun	<i>hih mite</i>	proximal demonstrative before a plural noun	well-supported	Gospel demonstrative comparanda are less clean than the OT anchor
noun + numeral / indefinite boundary	<i>mi khat</i>	noun followed by <i>khat</i> as numeral or indefinite-like modifier	supported with caveat	overlaps with the numerals and indefinites boundary
noun + numeral	<i>ni li</i>	counted noun followed by a simple numeral	well-supported	numeral formation belongs to the numerals section
noun + numeral	<i>kum sawm le nih</i>	counted noun followed by a compound numeral	well-supported	compound-ten analysis belongs to the numerals section

Pattern	Example form	Rough function	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
noun + quantifier	<i>mi khempeuh</i>	noun followed by a total quantifier	well-supported	full quantifier semantics belong to the quantifiers section
noun + quantifier	<i>mi pawlkhat</i>	noun followed by an existential or partitive-like quantifier	supported with caveat	grouping semantics remain caveated
noun + quantifier	<i>mi tampi</i>	noun followed by a quantity modifier	supported with caveat	borders on broader degree or adjective-like modification
possessor + possessed NP	<i>na pa' inn-ah</i>	pronominal possessor with possessed noun phrase	supported with caveat	overlaps with possessive prefixes, apostrophe analysis, and case closure
possessed NP chain	<i>a zi' min</i>	possessor-marked noun phrase containing a possessed noun	supported with caveat	does not yet justify a full possession paradigm

2.3.3 Demonstratives and nouns

The clearest checked demonstrative-related anchor remains *hih mite*, which safely supports a demonstrative-before-noun description for the current evidence. That is a narrower and safer claim than a full theory of determiner position. The demonstratives section remains the right place for the broader deictic inventory; the present section only uses the NP row to show that demonstrative-related modification does not pattern like the postnominal numeral and quantifier rows.

- (2.20) *hih mi-tè*
 PROX person-PL
 ‘these people’ (Exodus 5:5)

Matthew 6:2 gives a Gospel comparandum in *a hih mite*, but that row is embedded in a larger relative-like phrase and is therefore less clean as a simple adnominal demonstrative anchor. For present purposes, the OT phrase above remains the better controlled example.

No equally clean Gospel demonstrative example is currently used here, so the subsection stays with the compact OT anchor while the embedded Gospel comparandum remains only a supporting note.

2.3.4 Numerals and nouns

The normalized numerals section already carries the fuller description of the numeral system, including compound tens and larger-number expressions. The current NP section uses numeral material only to support noun-plus-numeral order: the cleanest checked rows place the noun before the numeral rather than the numeral before the noun.

- (2.21) *ni li*
 day four
 ‘four days’ (John 11:39)

-
- (2.22) *kúm sàwm lè nih*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

These rows show that the pattern is not tied to a single lexical head. *Ni li* 'four days' and *kum sawm le nih* 'twelve years' both keep the noun before the numeral, even when the numeral itself is compound. At the same time, *mi khat* 'one person / a person' remains an explicit boundary row, since the present section uses it as NP-order evidence without resolving the full numeral versus indefinite analysis that belongs to the numerals and quantifier-adjacent discussion.

2.3.5 Quantifiers and nouns

The quantifiers section already carries the fuller discussion of total, existential-like, and negative-licensed quantifier material. Here the relevant point is more limited: the cleanest checked quantifier rows also place the noun before the quantifier-like item.

- (2.23) *mì khèmpèuh*
person all
'all people' (Luke 2:1)

- (2.24) *mì pàwl-khàt*
person some-one
'some people' (Matthew 2:1)

Mi pawlkhat and *mi tampi* (Mark 6:34) support the same general noun-plus-quantifier profile, although each keeps its own semantic caveats from the normalized quantifiers section. The current section therefore uses them as modest NP-order evidence rather than as a reopened quantifier chapter.

2.3.6 Possession

Possession is now printable in a cautious way, but it remains less normalized than the modifier-order material above. The safest current claim is that the checked possession rows show possessor-before-possession order inside the noun phrase. They do not yet justify a full paradigm of possessive prefixes, a settled treatment of apostrophe marking, or a broad theory of alienable versus inalienable possession.

- (2.25) *nà pa' inn-àh*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC
'in thy father's house' (Genesis 24:23)

- (2.26) *à zi' mīn*
3SG wife.POSS name
'his wife's name' (Genesis 3:20)

These rows are enough for a cautious description of possessor-before-possession structure, especially when read together with the main anchors *ka pa*, *Topa' inn*, and *a pa' inn*. They are not enough for a full possession paradigm, because the current evidence still overlaps with pronouns and possessive prefixes, genitive or apostrophe analysis, relator and postposition structure, and broader questions about head-dependent order.

No equally clean Gospel possession row was found for here under current careful evidence control. The possession subsection therefore remains OT-led even though the section as a whole includes Gospel-balanced NP-order examples.

2.3.7 Deferred and boundary material

Several important possession and NP topics remain explicitly deferred.

- A full possession paradigm is still deferred: the present section does not normalize every possessive prefix or every nominal host.
- Kinship possession remains under-supported beyond a few controlled anchors such as *ka pa*.
- Pronominal possession and agreement overlap remains shared with the pronoun and prefix/agreement material rather than settled here.
- Apostrophe-marked relations such as *Topa' inn* remain promising, but their exact relation to genitive marking and title-like noun combinations still needs fuller normalization.
- *Topa' tungah* remains a relator or case-boundary row rather than a clean possession example.
- *ka suahna leitang* remains a nominalization boundary row rather than a core possession anchor.
- Demonstrative, numeral, and quantifier rows are used here for NP-order support only; their full systems remain in the demonstratives, numerals, and quantifiers sections.
- Analyzer-noisy or report-only material, including isolated prefix surfaces and broad recursive-possession claims, is not promoted into the present discussion here.

2.3.8 Summary

The NP structure / possession section can now support a modest description of noun phrase order: the cleanest current evidence points to demonstrative-before-noun structure alongside noun-plus-postnominal numeral and quantifier patterns. Possession is now visible enough to include with formal examples, but it remains a cautious subsection whose broader paradigm, marking analysis, and interface with pronouns, genitive structure, and relators are still explicitly deferred.

2.4 Noun domain

The noun-domain evidence is strongest for simple stems such as *gam* ‘land / country’ and *aksi* ‘star’, for plural *-te*, and for nouns that remain visible as heads inside larger phrases.

2.4.1 Overview of the noun domain

The clearest current evidence supports a modest but coherent noun-domain description. Simple lexical nouns such as *gam* ‘land / country’ and *aksi* ‘star’ are safely attested, and plural marking with *-te* is printable for controlled anchors such as *aksi-te* ‘stars’ and *mite* ‘people’. Human noun *mi* ‘person’ is also a stable lexical head in larger noun phrases, as seen in rows such as *mi khat* ‘one person / a person’, *mi khempeuh* ‘all people’, *mi pawlkhat* ‘some people’, and *mi tampi* ‘many people’, while nonhuman nouns such as *ni* ‘day’ and *kum* ‘year’ behave similarly in counted phrases.

This is enough to describe a small noun inventory, to note a cautious *-te* plural pattern, and to show that lexical nouns remain visible as heads inside demonstrative, numeral, and quantifier phrases. It is not yet enough for a full noun-domain chapter, because compounds, proper names, classifier-like nouns, and nominalized nouns still require more boundary control.

Gospel searches produced usable noun-domain evidence for *aksi* ‘star’, *mi khempeuh* ‘all people’, *ni li* ‘four days’, and proper-name material such as *Abraham' suan David* ‘David, descendant of Abraham’, which helps keep the section from becoming Genesis-only. The cleanest *gam* ‘land / country’ and *-te* plural anchors, however, remain OT-led in the current stage, while compound material such as *minam* ‘nation / people-group’ still needs explicit caveats.

2.4.2 Current noun-domain inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
<i>gam</i>	simple common noun ‘land / country’	<i>gam sung</i>	well-supported	semantic range varies across geographic and political contexts current Gospel anchor occurs inside a possessed phrase does not yet settle the full behavior of plural / collective marking overlaps with quantified and counted NP structure discussed elsewhere demonstrative and NP-order analysis belongs to other sections numeral semantics belong to the numerals section compound numeral analysis belongs to the numerals section compound transparency and lexicalization remain under review does not yet justify a full proper-noun system
<i>aksi</i>	simple common noun ‘star’	<i>ama aksi</i>	supported with caveat	
<i>aksi-te</i>	noun with <i>-te</i> plural marking	<i>aksi-te</i>	well-supported	
<i>mi</i>	human common noun ‘person’	<i>mi khat, mi khempueh</i>	well-supported	
<i>mi-te / mite</i>	human plural noun	<i>hih mite</i>	well-supported	
<i>ni</i>	noun head in counted phrase	<i>ni li</i>	well-supported	
<i>kum</i>	noun head in counted phrase	<i>kum sawm le nih</i>	well-supported	
<i>mi-nam / minam</i>	transparent compound noun	<i>minam khat</i>	supported with caveat	
<i>Abraham</i>	proper name used inside a larger noun phrase	<i>Abraham’ suan David</i>	supported with caveat	

2.4.3 Simple noun stems

The safest simple-stem anchors remain *gam* and *aksi*. *gam* is a robust nonhuman common noun in the noun reports, while *aksi* is visible both in older OT material and in a clean Gospel phrase that keeps the stem separate from plural marking. These rows are enough to show that the noun section is not limited to derived forms or larger noun phrases: basic lexical stems are directly attested.

At the same time, the current section keeps the claim narrow. It does not attempt to classify all noun semantics or all stem alternations; it only records that ordinary lexical nouns can be cited safely before the analysis moves on to plural marking and larger NP environments.

- (2.27) *gàm sùng*
land inside
‘in the land’ (Genesis 2:5)

-
- (2.28) *àmà* *aksi*
 3SG.POSS star
 ‘his star’ (Matthew 2:2)

2.4.4 Plural marking with -te

Plural marking with *-te* is now safe to discuss in a limited way. The clearest noun-domain anchors are nonhuman *aksi-te* and human *mi-te* in the fused form *mite*. Taken together, they support a modest claim that *-te* marks plurality on nouns in examples.

The present section does not claim that every plural or collective pattern has been normalized. Broader questions about distributive readings, plurality outside simple noun stems, and the interaction of plural marking with quantification are still deferred.

- (2.29) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:noun-aksi-te: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

aksi-tè
 star-PL

 ‘stars’ (Genesis 1:16)

- (2.30) *hìh* *mì-tè*
 PROX person-PL
 ‘these people’ (Exodus 5:5)

2.4.5 Human nouns and common nouns

Human noun *mi* is now one of the clearest lexical noun anchors in the nominal domain. It appears as a simple noun stem and as the head of several already-normalized noun phrases, including *mi khat*, *mi khempeuh*, *mi pawlkhat*, and *mi tampi*. Its plural form *mite* is equally secure in the current evidence.

This matters for the noun domain because it shows that the normalized NP, numeral, and quantifier sections are reusing genuine noun heads rather than unanalyzed filler forms. The NP structure section remains the right place for broader ordering claims, but the noun domain can now safely say that *mi* and *mite* are stable human common nouns.

- (2.31) *mì* *khàt*
 person one
 ‘a man / one person’ (Genesis 32:24)

- (2.32) *mì* *khèmpèuh*
 person all
 ‘all people’ (Luke 2:1)

2.4.6 Nouns in larger phrases

The normalized numerals, quantifiers, and NP structure / possession sections already show that nouns remain visible as heads in larger phrases. In the current noun-domain pass, that point can be stated modestly: noun heads such as *mì*, *nì*, and *kum* stay lexically identifiable inside counted and quantified expressions rather than disappearing into unanalyzed templates.

Nì li ‘four days’ and *kum sawm le nìh* ‘twelve years’ are the clearest counted anchors for this purpose. Together they show that lexical noun heads remain visible inside larger numeral phrases. The noun-domain claim is therefore limited to lexical headedness; it does not reopen the fuller NP-order or numeral/quantifier analyses.

(2.33) *nì li*
day four
'four days' (John 11:39)

(2.34) *kúm sàwm lè nih*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

2.4.7 Compounds and proper nouns

Compounds and proper nouns are now visible enough for a cautious note, but they remain less normalized than simple stems and plural-marked nouns. The clearest compound-like anchor is *minam*, which is still transparent enough to support a controlled print comment about noun-noun composition. Proper names such as *Abraham* are also clearly nominal, but the current evidence is not yet strong enough to generalize over Bible names, place names, or analyzer-noisy multiword name strings.

The current section therefore treats compounds and proper nouns as boundary material with one safe compound example and one cautious proper-name example. *Abraham' suan David* is a useful comparandum, but it does not yet justify a full proper-name subsection or a complete account of name-internal structure.

(2.35) *mì-nam khàt*
person-kind one
'one nation' (Genesis 11:6)

(2.36) *Abraham' suan David*
ABRAHAM.POSS plant DAVID
'David, descendant of Abraham' (Matthew 1:1)

2.4.8 Nominalization boundary

Derived nouns and nominalized forms remain shared with the nominalization section. Items such as *kholhna* and broader *-na* material are important for the nominal domain, but the present section does not absorb them into the lexical noun inventory. It only notes that lexical nouns, plural-marked nouns, and larger noun phrases have now been normalized far enough that nominalized nouns can be kept as an explicit boundary rather than being mixed into the basic noun list.

2.4.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several noun-domain topics remain explicitly deferred.

- Transparent compounds remain only partially normalized: *minam* is useful, but broader compound classes still need more evidence.
- Lexicalized compounds remain deferred because current report evidence does not cleanly separate synchronically analyzable forms from frozen lexemes.
- Proper nouns remain boundary-heavy: *Abraham* is usable as a controlled anchor, but Bible person and place names are not yet normalized as a full subsystem.
- Classifier-like nouns and measure-like nominal heads remain shared with numeral and quantifier work rather than settled here.
- Kinship nouns remain partly shared with possession, especially where forms such as *pa*, *inn*, and *min* enter possessor constructions.
- Nominalized nouns in *-na* remain with the nominalization section rather than being promoted as basic noun stems here.
- Plural and number patterns beyond straightforward *-te* marking remain deferred.
- Analyzer-noisy noun labels and multiword proper-name strings are not promoted into the present discussion.
- Raw report-only noun lists are not treated as grammar facts without checked careful evidence control.

2.4.10 Summary

The noun domain can now support a fuller section than the earlier narrow section allowed. Current evidence safely identifies simple noun stems such as *gam* and *aksi*, a cautious *-te* plural pattern visible in *aksi-te* and *mite*, stable human noun heads such as *mi*, and lexical nouns that remain visible inside counted and quantified noun phrases. Compounds, proper nouns, and nominalized nouns are now better framed as explicit boundary material rather than being mixed into an under-controlled noun list (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.5 Case marking

The current case evidence centers on *-ah* ‘locative / goal-like’ and *-in* ‘ergative / agentive’, while *-pan* ‘source / ablative’, *-panin* ‘source / departure’, and *-tawh* ‘with’ remain more cautious oblique extensions.

2.5.1 Overview of case-like marking

The current evidence supports a modest but coherent picture of postnominal case-like marking in Tedim. The clearest claims concern locative or goal-like *-ah* ‘locative / goal-like’ and clause-level agentive or ergative *-in* ‘ergative / agentive’. The same section also supports more cautious discussion of source marking with *-pan* ‘source / ablative’ and *-panin* ‘source / departure’, plus accompaniment or material-extension uses of *-tawh* ‘with’, but those markers remain more boundary-heavy because they overlap with relator nouns, postpositions, or broader semantic extension.

The safest current prose therefore treats case marking as an NP-final domain rather than as a fully settled paradigm of discrete suffixes. Plain noun-plus-case rows such as *khua-ah* ‘in the town’ and clause-level agent rows such as *Kain in* ‘Cain as agent’ are secure enough to print. Relator-hosted forms such as *lakpan* ‘from among’ and *David khuapi sungah* ‘in the city of David’ are also real, but they should not be collapsed into a bare suffix inventory. Apostrophe-marked possession can host the same NP-final marking, yet the apostrophe itself remains a boundary issue rather than a settled genitive case marker in this section.

The Gospel search was productive enough to keep the section from becoming OT-only. The current manually reviewed supplement adds usable Gospel support for *Herod in* ‘Herod as agent’, *keima inn-ah* ‘into my house’, *David khuapi sungah* ‘in the city of David’, and *lakpan* ‘from among’. The possessive-boundary example remains OT-led, because no equally compact Gospel row was as clean under the current control standard.

2.5.2 Current case-marking inventory

Marker or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
<i>-ah</i>	locative or goal-like NP-final marking	<i>khua-ah, inn-ah</i>	well-supported	must stay distinct from deferred tone-sensitive <i>-a</i> and from relator-hosted spatial phrases
<i>-in</i>	clause-level ergative or agentive marking	<i>Kain in, Herod in</i>	well-supported	raw <i>-in</i> extraction overgenerates forms such as <i>ciangin</i>
possessor phrase plus <i>-ah</i>	possessed NP closed by case-like marking	<i>na pa' inn-ah</i>	supported with caveat	does not settle the apostrophe or genitive analysis

Marker or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
<i>-pan</i>	source marking, often on a relator host	<i>lakpan</i>	supported with caveat	current clean evidence is relator-hosted rather than a broad bare-suffix paradigm
<i>-panin</i>	source or departure marking	<i>inn panin</i>	supported with caveat	internal structure remains under review
<i>-tawh</i>	accompaniment, with material or instrumental extension	<i>kei tawh, leivui tawh</i>	supported with caveat	accompaniment should not be flattened together with material-extension use
relator noun plus case	spatial relational phrase closed by case-like marking	<i>David khuapi sungah, tungah, kiangah</i>	supported with caveat	belongs jointly with the relators / postpositions section rather than a suffix-only list

2.5.3 Locative and goal marking with -ah

The clearest present claim is that *-ah* is a locative or goal-like case marker at the right edge of the noun phrase. The primary checked control is plain noun-plus-locative *khua-ah*, while the new source-balance supplement adds a compact Gospel goal-like example with *keima inn-ah*. This is enough to describe *-ah* as marking location and destination-like relations without forcing a sharper split among locative, allative, and general oblique labels than the current evidence can support.

The section also keeps one important negative control explicit. The current evidence does **not** justify collapsing deferred *-a* material into *-ah*. The source inventory and case background notes both keep tone-sensitive or otherwise ambiguous *-a* questions unresolved, so the description remains narrower than a full locative or allative chapter.

- (2.37) *khua-àh*
town-LOC
'in the town' (Genesis 11:28)

- (2.38) *kèima inn-àh*
1SG.self house-LOC
'into my house' (Matthew 8:8)

These two rows together support the safest present wording. *khua-ah* keeps the simple noun-plus-case pattern visible, while *keima inn-ah* shows that the same marker naturally appears in a Gospel clause with motion toward a location. That is enough for cautious the present discussion, but not yet enough to decide whether every *-ah* token should be described as specifically locative, allative, or more generally oblique.

2.5.4 Agentive, ergative, or instrumental marking with -in

The present section supports an agentive or ergative analysis of *-in* more clearly than it supports any broader instrumental analysis. Genesis 4:3 remains the primary checked anchor because *Kain in* is the cleanest controlled

row. The new supplement adds Matthew 2:4 *Herod in* as a manually reviewed Gospel support example, which helps show that the pattern is not confined to one OT narrative window.

At the same time, this section does not claim a complete ergative system. It also does not promote a general instrumental *-in* category. The most important control here is still the homograph problem: raw searches for *-in* overgenerate forms such as *ciangin*, so only checked clause-level noun phrase rows are promoted into the grammar prose.

- (2.39) *Kain in*
KAIN ERG
‘Cain as transitive subject’ (Genesis 4:3)

- (2.40) *Herod in*
HEROD ERG
‘Herod as transitive subject’ (Matthew 2:4)

These examples are intentionally compact. They are not meant to reopen the full alignment chapter. They only show that a noun phrase can bear checked *-in* marking in a clause with a transitive predicate, and that this is stronger evidence than any uncontrolled *-in* string would be.

2.5.5 Other controlled oblique markers

The section still retains a small set of other controlled case-like markers, but they are best treated more cautiously than *-ah* and *-in*. Source marking with *-pan* and *-panin* is real enough to describe, especially in rows such as *lakpan* ‘from among’ and *inn panin* ‘from the house’, yet the cleanest *-pan* example is relator-hosted and the internal structure of *-panin* remains under review. Likewise, *-tawh* remains part of the section because *kei tawh* ‘with me’ is a clean accompaniment row and *leivui tawh* ‘with dust’ shows a material or instrument-like extension, but that semantic split needs to stay explicit.

This means the section can already mention *-pan*, *-panin*, and *-tawh* in the current inventory, but it should not yet present them as a fully normalized oblique subsystem. For the present pass, they remain controlled supporting material rather than the center of the case-marking chapter.

- (2.41) *inn pàn-in*
house ABL-ERG
‘from the house’ (Genesis 12:1)

- (2.42) *kèi tàwh*
1SG.PRO COM
‘with me’ (Genesis 14:24)

- (2.43) *leivui tàwh*
dust COM
‘with dust’ (Genesis 2:7)

These rows keep the oblique material concrete. *Inn panin* ‘from the house’ shows source marking without a relator host, while *kei tawh* ‘with me’ and *leivui tawh* ‘with dust’ show that *-tawh* covers both accompaniment and material-extension uses.

No equally clean Gospel source or accompaniment row is currently used here, so the subsection stays OT-led while the broader oblique inventory remains cautiously delimited.

2.5.6 Genitive / possessive boundary

The clearest way to discuss genitive or possessive boundary material at present is to show that an already possessed noun phrase can host case-like marking at its right edge. Genesis 24:23 gives the compact row *na pa' inn-ah* 'in your father's house', which is already reused in the normalized NP structure / possession section. Here it serves a narrower purpose: it shows that case-like marking closes the larger noun phrase rather than attaching only to a simple underived noun stem.

- (2.44) *na pa' inn-ah*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC
'in thy father's house' (Genesis 24:23)

This is enough to justify a boundary note, but not enough to settle the apostrophe analysis. The present section therefore does not settle whether the apostrophe material should be treated as a genitive suffix, a possessive linker, or an orthographic boundary convention. It only records that possessed noun phrases can participate in the same case-closing pattern that appears elsewhere in the nominal domain. The fuller discussion of possessive structure remains with the normalized NP structure / possession section.

No equally good Gospel possessed NP with case-like closure is currently used here, so the subsection stays with the compact OT example while the wider possession discussion remains elsewhere.

2.5.7 Case marking and relators/postpositions

The boundary with relators and postpositions is now one of the main editorial points of the section. Forms such as *sungah* 'inside / in', *tungah* 'on / upon', *kiangah* 'beside / near', and *lakpan* 'from among' are not noise, but neither are they simple proof that Tedim can be described by a suffix-only case list. The relational host matters: *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on top', *kiang* 'side / vicinity', and *lak* 'among' contribute spatial content before locative or source marking is added.

- (2.45) *David khua-pì sùng-àh*
DAVID village-big inside-LOC
'in the city of David' (Luke 2:11)

- (2.46) *lak-pàn*
midst-ABL
'from among' (Matthew 5:19)

These rows belong here because they are case-like and NP-final. They also belong with the relators / postpositions section because the relational noun is part of the grammar, not just a carrier for a suffix. That is why forms such as *tungah* or *lakpan* should not be collapsed into case marking without careful evidence control. The best current solution is to let the two sections meet at the boundary rather than pretending the boundary does not exist.

2.5.8 Case marking and argument structure

The normalized case section can now say one modest thing about argument structure: checked *-in* rows such as *Kain in* 'Cain as agent' and *Herod in* 'Herod as agent' show case-marked noun phrases functioning as clause-level agents, while locative or goal-like rows such as *inn-ah* 'in / into the house' show noun phrases entering the clause as spatial arguments or adjuncts. That is enough to connect the nominal domain to clause structure without reopening the full alignment or valency chapter.

The present section therefore cross-references the transitivity section rather than replacing it. The transitivity section remains the place for fuller discussion of argument frames, lexical valency, and broader alignment questions. Case marking only contributes the controlled NP-final marking side of that picture here.

2.5.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several important topics remain explicitly deferred.

- A full case paradigm is still deferred; the present evidence is not yet enough for a full case paradigm.
- The ergative versus instrumental distinction for *-in* is not settled here.
- The finer split among locative, dative, allative, and general oblique functions is still under review.
- Tone-sensitive *-a* material remains blocked rather than being collapsed into *-ah*.
- Apostrophe or genitive analysis remains unresolved and stays shared with the NP structure / possession section.
- Possessive noun phrase overlap remains explicit, especially where possessed NPs then take *-ah*.
- Relator-noun and postposition structure remains shared with the relators / postpositions section.
- Full alignment and argument-structure claims remain shared with the transitivity section.
- *-panin* remains a controlled source-marking row without a fully settled internal analysis.
- *-tawh* remains split between accompaniment and material or instrumental extension.
- Analyzer-noisy or raw report-only marker rows are not promoted into the present discussion.
- Raw generated-report counts and broad analyzer output are not treated as grammar facts in this section.

2.5.10 Summary

The case-marking section can now support a fuller description than the earlier narrow section allowed. Current evidence safely supports clause-level *-in*, locative or goal-like *-ah*, a boundary note on possessed noun phrases such as *na pa' inn-ah*, and a controlled interface with relator-hosted forms such as *David khuapi sungah* and *lakpan*. Source marking with *-pan* and *-panin*, along with *-tawh*, remains usable but secondary and caveated. The result is a real grammar section with explicit limits, not a claim that the full Tedim case system has already been finished (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.6 Relators / postpositions

The current evidence supports relational nouns such as *sung* ‘inside’, *tung* ‘on / upon’, *kiang* ‘beside / near’, and *lak* ‘among / midst’, together with postpositional source patterns that close the larger phrase.

2.6.1 Overview of relators and postpositions

Tedim uses relational nouns and postpositional expressions to encode spatial and other relations, and case-like marking often appears at the right edge of the resulting phrase. The clearest current relator stems are *sung* ‘inside’, *tung* ‘on / upon’, *kiang* ‘beside / near’, *lak* ‘among / midst’, and the more cautious *pualam* ‘outside’. Related forms such as *laizang* ‘middle / midst’ point to the same semantic field, but the present section keeps its main discussion on the better-controlled relator stems (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

The main descriptive point is therefore structural rather than terminological. A form such as *sung* ‘inside’ or *kiang* ‘beside / near’ contributes spatial content of its own, while the phrase may still close with case-like material such as *-ah* ‘locative / goal-like’ or with source-marking *pan* ‘from’ and *panin* ‘from’. This is why the relator section and the case-marking section overlap without collapsing into each other.

2.6.2 Current relator / postposition inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
<i>sung</i>	interior relation	<i>David khuapi sungah</i>	well supported	most often appears with phrase-edge marking

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
<i>tung</i>	surface or superposed relation	<i>tua tui tungah</i>	supported with caveat	some uses remain close to broader oblique or abstract extensions
<i>kiang</i>	side, vicinity, or adjacency	<i>mipa kiangah</i>	supported with caveat	also overlaps with recipient-like and source-like uses
<i>lak</i>	among or amidst	<i>numeite lak panin</i>	well supported	source marking may be written as a separate form or a tighter unit
<i>pualam</i>	exterior or outside space	<i>kongkhak pualam</i>	cautious support	more lexical-nominal than the core four relator anchors
<i>sungah</i>	interior phrase closed by <i>-ah</i>	<i>David khuapi sungah</i>	well supported	shared with the case-marking discussion of phrase-edge <i>-ah</i>
<i>tungah</i>	surface relation closed by <i>-ah</i>	<i>tua tui tungah</i>	well supported	the relator stem and the edge marker both contribute meaning
<i>kiangah</i>	adjacency relation closed by <i>-ah</i>	<i>mipa kiangah</i>	supported with caveat	also touches recipient-like use in larger clause structure
<i>lakpan</i> / <i>lak panin</i>	source from an interior set	<i>lakpan, numeite lak panin</i>	well supported	fused and separated spellings both belong at the relator or case boundary
<i>NP + tawh</i>	accompaniment or associative postposition	<i>kei tawh</i>	supporting boundary pattern	shared with accompaniment and material-extension uses discussed under case marking

2.6.3 Spatial relator nouns

The clearest first point is that Tedim has spatial relator nouns, not only bare suffixes. In the current evidence, bare spatial use is especially easy to see with *pualam* ‘outside’, while the other stems frequently occur with additional edge marking. That asymmetry is itself informative: the relational noun remains visible even when another marker closes the phrase.

- (2.47) *kòng-khàk pualam*
 1SG→3-limit outside
 ‘outside the door’ (Mark 2:2)

- (2.48) *khua-pì pualam*
 village-big outside

‘outside the city’ (Genesis 24:11)

These examples keep the relator stem visible without forcing a larger claim about every spatial noun in the language. The same evidence domain also supports discussion of *sung* ‘inside’, *tung* ‘on / upon’, *kiang* ‘beside / near’, and *lak* ‘among / midst’, but those stems are most naturally illustrated below in phrases where a case-like or source-marking element closes the larger expression.

2.6.4 Relator plus case-like marking

When case-like marking is added, forms such as *sungah* ‘inside / in’, *tungah* ‘on / upon’, *kiangah* ‘beside / near’, and *lakpan* ‘from among’ show that the relational noun and the final marker both contribute to the construction. The resulting forms are real grammatical units, but the present evidence does not support treating them as if the relator had disappeared and only a suffix remained.

- (2.49) *David khua-pì sùng-àh*
DAVID village-big inside-LOC
‘in the city of David’ (Luke 2:11)

- (2.50) *túa tui tòngah*
DIST water on-LOC
‘upon the water’ (Genesis 1:2)

- (2.51) *mipa kiang-àh*
man beside-LOC
‘to the man / beside the man’ (Genesis 2:19)

- (2.52) *lak-pàn*
midst-ABL
‘from among’ (Matthew 5:19)

The examples are deliberately compact, because the descriptive issue is compact as well. *David khuapi sungah* and *tua tui tungah* show interior and surface relations closed by *-ah*, while *mipa kiangah* shows that adjacency expressions behave in the same way. *Lakpan* then shows that source marking can be hosted by the relator itself rather than by a simple noun stem.

2.6.5 Postpositional phrase structure

The current evidence also supports a modest structural claim about postpositional phrases. A relator or post-position follows the noun phrase that supplies its semantic anchor, and the whole sequence can then carry the source-like meaning of *pan* ‘from’ or *panin* ‘from’. This is clearest when the noun phrase before the relator is larger than a single bare noun.

- (2.53) *Pà kiang pàn-in*
father beside ABL-ERG
‘from the Father’ (John 6:45)

- (2.54) *numei-tè lāk pàn-in*
woman-PL among ABL-ERG
‘from among the women’ (Exodus 2:7)

These examples keep the structural claim modest. The section does not claim a single uniform analysis for every spelling alternation or every source-marking form. It only shows that the relational element is phrase-medial rather than invisible, because the noun phrase comes first and the postpositional or case-like material closes the expression afterward.

2.6.6 Case-marking boundary

The boundary with case marking remains explicit. Forms such as *sungah*, *tungah*, *kiangah*, and *lakpan* are shared with the case-marking section because both pieces of the construction matter: the relator contributes the spatial relation, and the final marker contributes locative or source-like closure. The case-marking section therefore remains responsible for the edge-marking side of the analysis, while the present section explains why the relational host is still grammatically visible.

This division of labor matters especially for *-ah*, *pan*, and *panin*. A phrase like *David khuapi sungah* is not just a bare locative suffix attached to *khuapi*, and *lakpan* is not just a bare ablative suffix detached from *lak*. The relator and the phrase-edge marker work together.

2.6.7 Possession and NP-structure boundary

The relator or postposition can follow a larger noun phrase rather than a simple stem. This is already visible in *David khuapi sungah* ‘in the city of David’, in kin-based phrases such as *Pa kiang panin* ‘from the Father’, and in possessed noun phrases such as *Faro’ inn sungah* ‘in Pharaoh’s house’. The structure is therefore phrase-closing rather than stem-bound.

The present section stops there. Fuller discussion of possessive marking and noun-phrase architecture remains with the NP structure / possession section, but that section and the present one now meet at a clear grammatical boundary.

2.6.8 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *nuai* and *mai* remain possible spatial nouns, but the current section does not promote them as core relator anchors.
- *tawhin* is still too sparse and too instrument-like to stand beside *pan*, *panin*, or *tawh* in the present account.
- The exact relation between tighter spellings such as *lakpan* and separated spellings such as *lak panin* remains open.
- Wider recipient-like uses around *kiang* still belong partly with clause structure and partly with case marking.
- Compound spatial nouns such as *laizang* remain relevant background, but they are not the center of the present section.

2.6.9 Summary

The current evidence supports a grammar-facing account of Tedim relators and postpositions. Spatial relations are carried by visible relational nouns such as *sung* ‘inside’, *tung* ‘on / upon’, *kiang* ‘beside / near’, *lak* ‘among / midst’, and cautiously *pualam* ‘outside’, while postpositional and case-like material closes the larger phrase. The result is a relational system whose structure is clearer once the relator and the phrase-edge marker are described together rather than forced into a suffix-only inventory (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.7 Numerals

The current numeral evidence supports a decimal system with basic cardinals, counted noun phrases, and *-na* ordinals, while larger-number and classifier-like material remain explicit boundary notes.

2.7.1 Overview of the numeral system

The current evidence supports a cautious but fuller overview of the Tedim numeral system. Tedim is described in the literature as a decimal system, with *sawm* ‘ten’ as the decimal base and *za* ‘hundred’ as the next larger base above the first two-digit range (Cing, 2017; Henderson, 1965). The Bible-backed review section confirms that basic cardinals, compound tens, larger-number expressions, *-na* ordinals such as *nihna* ‘second’, and at least one occurrence-counting expression such as *sawmvei* ‘ten times’ are all securely part of the current section.

This section therefore includes:

- decimal structure and the most useful cardinal bases;
- basic cardinal numerals and noun-plus-numeral counting phrases;
- compound tens and one Gospel teen expression;
- hundreds, thousands, and larger units only where the evidence is safe;
- ordinals with *-na*, anchored by *nihna*;
- counting expressions and classifier-like material, but only cautiously;
- occurrence-counting *sawmvei*;
- explicit ambiguity controls for numeral-side *kua* ‘nine’ and boundary *khat* ‘one’;
- distributive reduplication only as deferred material.

What it does **not** do is claim that the whole numeral chapter is finished. It does not promote raw generated-report counts as grammar facts, it does not normalize a full classifier system from thin evidence, and it does not import quantifier prose or dubious analyzer output without careful evidence control.

2.7.2 Cardinal numerals

The table below gives the core numeral inventory needed for the present section. It is orientation rather than a raw frequency table: the point is to show the basic system, while the formal examples below remain restricted to checked or newly checked normalization rows.

Value	Form	Current status in this section
1	<i>khat</i>	basic numeral; keep
2	<i>nih</i>	numeral/indefinite overlap explicit
3	<i>thum</i>	clean basic cardinal
4	<i>li</i>	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
5	<i>nga</i>	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
6	<i>guk</i>	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
7	<i>sagih</i>	clean basic cardinal in current examples
8	<i>giat</i>	basic cardinal recognized in the report/literature layer
9	<i>kua</i>	numeral <i>nine</i> only in constructionally numeral contexts
10	<i>sawm</i>	ten base
100	<i>za</i>	hundred base
1,000	<i>sing</i>	thousand base; not fully normalized in here
10,000	<i>tul</i>	larger unit recognized in the report/literature layer; not fully normalized in here

The table does not by itself authorize every form for immediate print-heavy exposition. It gives the section a visible inventory, while the examples below keep the actual printed claims small and checked.

2.7.3 Decimal composition

The safest current descriptive claim is that Tedim builds higher numerals through decimal composition, but the section should phrase that conservatively. The report and literature support a decimal structure (Cing, 2017;

[Henderson, 1965](#)), while the current evidence gives two especially useful checked examples: one Old Testament compound-ten anchor and one Gospel counted-noun expression with a compound numeral.

Genesis 5:9 remains the best controlled compound-ten anchor:

- (2.55) *kúm sàwm-kua*
year ten-nine
‘ninety years’ (Genesis 5:9)

Matthew 9:20 gives a good Gospel counted-noun expression with a compound numeral:

- (2.56) *kúm sàwm lè nih*
year ten and two
‘twelve years’ (Matthew 9:20)

These two rows are enough to support a modest decimal-composition claim. *Sawmkua* shows a clean compound-ten pattern and keeps numeral-side *kua* = *nine* visible in a securely numeral context. *Kum sawm le nih* ‘twelve years’ shows that a counted noun can also host a larger compound numeral in Gospel material, which helps the section avoid becoming a grammar of Genesis.

The section should still stop short of a full typology of every higher numeral pattern. The report mentions wider two-digit and larger-number combinations, but the present section only promotes the best checked examples.

Hundreds, thousands, and larger-number expressions are real parts of the system, but they need more caution than the simple and compound-ten rows. The current large-number anchor remains useful because it shows real biblical number style, not because every detail of the analyzer export is already polished:

- (2.57) *kúm zā-kua lè kúm sàwm-gùk lè kua*
year hundred-nine and year ten-six and who
‘nine hundred sixty and nine years’ (Genesis 5:27)

This is still a print-usable-with-caveat example. The wider construction is clearly numeral, but the export compresses *zā-kua*, and the final *kua* is glossed as *who* in the current export layer. The section therefore keeps the row with its analyzer caveat visible instead of pretending that the export is already perfect.

2.7.4 Ordinals

The safest current ordinal claim is that Tedim has *-na* ordinal formation, with *nihna* as the best controlled anchor. This is consistent with the report and literature ([Cing, 2017](#)).

- (2.58) *nih-ná*
two-NMLZ
‘second’ (Genesis 7:11)

Nihna is the current well-supported ordinal row. The background notes already notes that *pos_span* = *N* in the export; that is a label caveat, not a reason to reject the ordinal analysis.

Masa remains visible but deferred. Gospel material such as Matthew 10:2 confirms that *masa* is a live background form for ‘first’, but the present section does not yet promote it as the normalized ordinal anchor because the current checked section is still built around *nihna*, not around a full ordinal paradigm or a full contrast between *masa* and *khatna*-type forms.

No equally good Gospel ordinal example is currently used here, so the subsection stays anchored in the compact OT row while the broader ordinal evidence remains backgrounded.

2.7.5 Counting phrases and word order

The clearest current word-order claim is still modest: noun-plus-numeral patterns are securely attested. Counted nouns such as *kum* ‘year’ and *ni* ‘day’ clearly precede the numeral in the best current examples, and the section now keeps both Old Testament and Gospel evidence visible for that pattern.

(2.59) *kúm nih*
year two
‘two years’ (Genesis 11:10)

(2.60) *nì sagih*
day seven
‘seven days’ (Genesis 7:10)

(2.61) *nì li*
day four
‘four days’ (John 11:39)

These are clean counted-noun examples, and they justify a real statement that noun-plus-numeral order is well supported. The section should still avoid overclaiming a complete typology of numeral placement. The broader report layer contains more patterns, and the literature discusses wider numeral syntax, but the checked section should stop at what the current examples support directly.

The Gospel search for this pilot found good counted-noun examples such as *ni li* ‘four days’ and *kum sawm le nih* ‘twelve years’. That is enough to improve source balance. It does **not** mean that every numeral construction in the section now has an equally good Gospel counterpart.

2.7.6 Classifier-like and counting expressions

The report and literature mention classifier-like material and counting expressions, but the current section should stay selective. Only the rows that are checked or newly checked for this pilot should be promoted.

The safest current occurrence-counting row is still *sawmvei*:

(2.62) *sàwm-vei*
ten-times
‘ten times’ (Genesis 31:7)

The generated report paraphrases this as *vei sawm*, but the current analyzer export preserves the fused form *sawmvei*. That export-backed *sawmvei* form means the fused form should control the present slice.

Mi khat ‘one person / a person’ remains valuable boundary evidence:

(2.63) *mì khàt*
person one
‘a man’ / ‘one person’ (Genesis 32:24)

This is why the section discusses *mi khat* here but does not treat it as an uncomplicated bare numeral *one* example. It should not be treated as an uncomplicated bare numeral *one* example. It sits exactly on the numeral/indefinite boundary.

The classifier-like material can therefore be summarized cautiously:

Expression or form	Current treatment	Reason
<i>mi khat</i>	supported with caveat	numeral/indefinite boundary, not a simple classifier row
<i>sawmvei</i>	supported with caveat	clear occurrence-counting expression
<i>pa, nu, zat, tei</i>	deferred	promising report/literature material, but not normalized in here

This means the section can talk about classifier-like and counting expressions without pretending that the full classifier system has already been normalized. It also means the section does not start a quantifiers retrofit here.

No equally clean Gospel classifier-like example is currently used here, so the subsection keeps the compact OT anchors while the broader classifier-like inventory remains explicitly delimited.

2.7.7 Distributive numerals

Distributive numerals remain deferred in this pilot. The previous generated-report claim for distributive *sagih sagih* is not well-supported because the current analyzer/checked evidence still does not support the repeated span in the key Genesis 7:2 row. The generated report is useful background orientation, but it should not outrun the current checked evidence.

This is exactly the kind of place where normalization must stay disciplined. The section can say that distributive reduplication is a promising area in the report and literature, but it should still defer *sagih sagih* until the analyzer-backed evidence is clean enough to promote.

2.7.8 Ambiguity controls

Two ambiguity controls remain central to the section: *kua* ‘nine’ must stay in clearly numeral contexts so that it is not confused with the interrogative form *kua* ‘who’, and *khat* ‘one’ still needs explicit boundary notes where numeral and indefinite-like uses overlap.

Form	Numeral-side use	Competing use	Current treatment
<i>kua</i>	<i>sawmkua</i> ; Genesis 5:27 large-number phrase	interrogative <i>who</i>	print only in constructionally numeral contexts
<i>khat</i>	basic cardinal ‘one’	indefinite-like readings such as <i>mi khat</i>	keep explicit boundary notes; do not overgeneralize article-like use

The blocked *kua* control remains Genesis 48:8:

Hihte kua ahi hiam?

That row belongs to the interrogatives section, not to numerals. Future numerals prose must therefore not use raw *kua* hits as numeral evidence.

The *khat* side of the control is different. *Khat* is unquestionably part of the numeral inventory, but not every *khat* example is equally good as a bare numeral illustration. The best currently controlled boundary row is still *mi khat*, and no cleaner Gospel *khat* boundary example was strong enough to replace it in this pilot.

2.7.9 Summary

The normalized numerals section now supports a genuine description. Tedim has a decimal numeral system with basic cardinals, compound tens, larger bases such as *za*, *sing*, and *tul*, *-na* ordinals, noun-plus-numeral counting phrases, and at least one compact occurrence-counting expression. The section now includes multiple formal examples, a visible inventory table, and both Old Testament and Gospel evidence where the checked material allows it.

At the same time, the section keeps the important boundaries explicit. *Sawmvei* remains tied to its fused-export caveat; the Genesis 5:27 large-number phrase remains usable only with analyzer caveats; *mi khat* remains boundary evidence; *kua* must stay constructionally controlled; and distributive *sagih sagih* remains deferred until the repeated span is genuinely analyzer-backed.

2.8 Quantifiers

The current quantifier evidence centers on *khempeuh* ‘all’, *pawlkhat* ‘some people’, *kuamah* ‘nobody’, *bangmah* ‘nothing’, and noun-plus-quantifier phrases such as *mi tampi* ‘many people’.

2.8.1 Overview of quantification in Tedim

The current evidence supports a modest but real account of quantification in Tedim. The safest core anchor is universal or total *khempeuh* ‘all’. Existential or indefinite-like quantification is visible through *pawlkhat* ‘some people’ or more cautiously ‘some’, but that material still carries a partitive or alternative-grouping caveat. *khat* ‘one’ remains boundary evidence shared with numerals rather than an uncomplicated quantifier anchor. Negative-quantifier work is currently safest with *kuamah* ‘nobody’ and *bangmah* ‘nothing’ or ‘anything’ only where clear clause-level negation licenses them. Quantity-related material is also visible through *tampi* ‘many’, especially in *tampi tak* ‘very many / much’ and noun-phrase *mi tampi* ‘many people’, but those rows still border on broader degree or modification work rather than constituting a full independent quantifier subsystem.

This is also where the current evidence meets broader descriptive literature most clearly: quantification in Tedim overlaps with noun-phrase structure, indefiniteness, and negation rather than forming a neatly isolated paradigm (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

The present section therefore keeps five safe claims in view. First, *khempeuh* supports a modest universal or total-quantifier generalization. Second, *pawlkhat* supports existential or indefinite-like readings with an explicit grouping caveat. Third, *kuamah* and *bangmah* remain usable only in negative-licensed clauses. Fourth, noun phrases such as *mi khempeuh* ‘all people’, *mi pawlkhat* ‘some people’, and *mi tampi* ‘many people’ support only a modest noun-plus-quantifier discussion. Fifth, *peuhpeuh*, *tawm*, *zaw*, and *mahmah* remain visible as boundary material without broadening the section into a full free-choice, low-quantity, comparative, or intensifier chapter.

2.8.2 Quantifier inventory

The table below summarizes the forms that are currently safe enough to discuss in the section.

Form	Rough function	Constructional status	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
<i>khempeuh</i>	universal / total quantifier	safe in checked noun phrases and scoped nominal expressions	well-supported	does not yet justify a full universal/distributive system
<i>pawlkhat</i>	existential / indefinite-like quantifier	usable in partitive or group-indefinite contexts	supported with caveat	grouping / alternative-set nuance remains explicit

Form	Rough function	Constructional status	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
<i>khat in mi khat</i>	numeral / indefinite boundary material	usable only as boundary evidence	supported with caveat	overlaps directly with numerals and indefinites
<i>kuamah</i>	negative-licensed human quantifier	safe in checked negative clauses	supported with caveat	depends on explicit negation
<i>bangmah</i>	negative-licensed nonhuman quantifier	safe in checked negative clauses	supported with caveat	overlaps with broader bang-family material outside negation
<i>tampi tak</i>	quantity / degree expression	compact quantity-related anchor	supported with caveat	borders on broader degree-modification work
<i>tampi in mi tampi</i>	quantity in noun phrase structure	usable as noun-plus-quantity row	supported with caveat	must not be widened into a full adjective/adverb chapter
<i>peuhpeuh</i>	free-choice / distributive-looking material	visible but not stabilized as core quantifier evidence	deferred	current rows lean toward free-choice or discourse readings
<i>tawm</i>	low-quantity edge material	report-visible but export-noisy	deferred	current analyzer gloss is too noisy for discussion here
<i>zaw</i>	comparative edge row	visible only as boundary material	boundary item	comparison is not normalized as part of the core quantifier chapter
<i>mahmah</i>	intensifier edge row	visible only as boundary material	boundary item	intensification belongs to broader modification work, not the core quantifier chapter

2.8.3 Universal / total quantifiers

Khempeuh remains the clearest current universal or total-quantifier anchor. The original main anchor is still Genesis 2:1, which gives a well-scoped nominal expression and keeps the printed claim conservative.

- (2.64) *vàn-tùng léi-tùng lè à sùng-à òm-tè khèmpeuh*
 sky-on land-on and 3SG inside-3SG exist-PL all
 ‘the heavens and the earth, and all that was in them’ (Genesis 2:1)

The section also adds a clean Gospel counterpart so that the section does not become another Genesis-heavy chapter.

- (2.65) *mì khèmpeuh*
 person all
 ‘all people’ / ‘everyone’ (Luke 2:1)

Together these rows support a modest claim: total quantification is safely visible in noun-phrase-like structures, and *khempeuh* is currently the best anchor. Matthew 2:3 *Jerusalem khuami khempeuh* points in the same direction

and supports the same noun-plus-quantifier pattern, but the printed section does not need to turn that into a broad universal/distributive system or a report-driven frequency claim.

2.8.4 Existential / indefinite-like quantifiers

Existential or indefinite-like quantification is currently safest around *pawlkhat*, but the section's original Genesis 32:8 control still has to be read as partitive or alternative-grouping evidence rather than as an uncomplicated bare *some*.

For the section, a checked Gospel noun-phrase example helps show the construction more clearly in print:

- (2.66) *mì pàwl-khàt*
person some-one
'some people' (Matthew 2:1)

This Gospel row is useful because it makes the noun-phrase behavior clearer, but the Genesis 32:8 main anchor still controls the interpretation. *Pawlkhat* therefore remains grouped, partitive, or alternative-set material rather than a fully normalized article-like determiner.

The existential or indefinite-like subsection also has to keep *khat* on the boundary with numerals.

- (2.67) *mì khàt*
person one
'a man' / 'one person' (Genesis 32:24)

Mì khat 'one person / a person' is reused from the numerals section as boundary evidence. The present section does not treat *khat* 'one' as an uncomplicated quantifier anchor. Instead, it keeps the numeral/indefinite overlap explicit and lets the numerals section carry the fuller discussion of *one*.

2.8.5 Quantifiers and negation

The section still handles negative quantifier material conservatively. *Kuamah* and *bangmah* are safe only in clearly negative-licensed clauses, so the section should cross-reference, not reopen, the stabilized negation section.

- (2.68) *kuamah mú lò*
nobody see.I NEG
'he saw nobody' / 'he saw no man' (Exodus 2:12)

- (2.69) *kuamah in bangmah hih théi lò hì*
nobody ERG nothing PROX know NEG DECL
'nobody can do anything' (John 3:27)

These two rows show the safest current pattern. Human-domain *kuamah* and nonhuman-domain *bangmah* are usable in print only where the negative licensing is explicit. The original Genesis 39:9 row *bangmah om lo hi* remains the compact checked nonhuman anchor behind this subsection, but John 3:27 gives the section a good Gospel example without loosening the negation caveat.

The section must also keep blocked bang-family material visible. *Tua bangmah hi-in* from Exodus 27:11 remains a blocked control rather than ordinary negative-quantifier evidence. That control prevents the quantifiers section from absorbing every *bangmah* token outside clear negative licensing.

2.8.6 Quantifiers and noun phrase structure

The safest noun-phrase claim is still modest. The checked examples support noun-plus-quantifier combinations such as *mi khempueh*, *mi pawlkhat*, and *mi tampi*, but they do not yet justify a full noun-phrase ordering chapter covering demonstratives, numerals, and all quantifier types.

- (2.70) *mi tampi*
person many
‘many people’ (Mark 6:34)

This is where the section can integrate quantity material without broadening uncontrollably. The original section’s *tampi tak* row is still the main quantity/degree anchor, but *mi tampi* gives the section a cleaner noun-phrase example. The printed claim should therefore stay narrow: Tedim clearly allows noun-plus-quantifier or noun-plus-quantity combinations in at least some checked rows, but the present section does not yet settle a full NP-ordering typology.

No equally good second formal example is repeated here, because this subsection gathers the noun-plus-quantifier evidence already illustrated above rather than restaging each earlier construction.

2.8.7 Deferred and boundary material

Several quantifier-looking domains still need to stay visibly non-normalized.

Topic	Current treatment	Reason for caution
numeral overlap with <i>khat</i>	supported with caveat	<i>mi khat</i> is shared boundary evidence and should not be detached from the numerals discussion
negative quantifier overlap	supported with caveat	<i>kuamah</i> and <i>bangmah</i> are safe only with explicit negation
pronoun / determiner overlap	deferred beyond modest NP discussion	current examples support only local noun-phrase claims, not a full determiner system
discourse / scope readings with <i>peuhpeuh</i>	deferred	current rows lean toward free-choice or broad-indefinite readings rather than settled universal quantification
low-quantity <i>tawm</i>	deferred	current export gloss remains too noisy for print promotion
<i>tampi tak</i> versus broader degree work	supported with caveat	useful quantity evidence, but not the start of a broad adjective/adverb chapter
<i>zaw</i> and <i>mahmah</i>	edge rows only	keep comparison and intensification visible without widening the section into a full comparison or intensifier chapter
bang-family false friends such as <i>tua bangmah hi-in</i>	blocked control	prevents overgeneration from raw bang-family report material

This is also the right place to keep the source-balance search honest. Gospel searches produced useful rows for *khempueh*, *pawlkhat*, *tampi*, and negative-licensed *kuamah* / *bangmah*, so the section now has genuine Old Testament and Gospel coverage. The same search did not yield a cleaner Gospel replacement for the classic *mi khat* boundary row, and Gospel *peuhpeuh* material remained too free-choice or discourse-heavy to promote as settled core quantifier evidence.

2.8.8 Summary

The quantifiers section now reads as a real grammar section rather than a narrow section note. *Khempeuh* remains the clearest universal anchor; *pawlkhat* remains useful existential or indefinite-like evidence with a grouping caveat; *khat* remains explicit numeral/indefinite boundary material; *kuamah* and *bangmah* remain tied to clear negative licensing; and *tampi* material now supports a modest noun-phrase discussion without widening into a broad modification chapter.

What remains deferred is equally important. The section still does not claim a full universal/distributive system, a full determiner system, a full negative-quantifier chapter, or a full degree/intensifier/comparative chapter. It keeps checked evidence and explicit caveats in front of the reader, uses Gospel examples where they genuinely help, and leaves *peuhpeuh*, *tawm*, and other boundary-heavy material clearly marked for later review.

3 Predicate structure and verbal morphology

3.1 Stem alternation

3.1.1 Verb-stem alternation

This file is now a **draft argument plan**, not the final polished grammar section. The eventual prose should not be organized only by print status. It should discuss **both syntactic contexts and individual verb pairs**, in that order:

1. system-wide Form I / Form II distribution by syntactic context;
2. the strongest illustrative pairs;
3. pair-by-pair caveated and difficult evidence;
4. one-sided, control, and rejected material.

Earlier descriptions agree that Tedim has a two-form verbal system, even though the terminology differs. Henderson describes Form I and Form II, while Zam Ngaih Cing speaks of Stem 1 and Stem 2 (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). The present review section keeps those descriptive traditions in view, but it now separates coverage, promotion, and quotation safety much more explicitly than the earlier broad analyzer table did.

The Form I / Form II contrast The opening section of the eventual grammar should introduce the system with the strongest lexical pairs, not with the widest possible inventory.

- **Core starting point:** *mu ~ muh*, *ne ~ nek*, *nei ~ neih*.
- **Basic descriptive claim:** Form I is especially clear in ordinary finite predication and many main-clause uses. Form II is especially visible in dependent, temporal, purposive, attributive, nominalized, and other constructionally bound environments.
- **Immediate caution:** do not reduce the system to slogans such as *Form II = subordinate*, *Form II = negative*, *Form I = finite*, or *Form II = nominalized only*.

The argument here should stay structural and distributional before it becomes lexical and pair-specific.

The eventual section will likely need five editorial surfaces:

- a **small core showcase table**;
- a **larger promoted-pair inventory table**;
- a **pair-by-pair discussion section**;
- a **one-sided / same-form / functional coverage table**;
- a **blocked or analyzer-noise table / appendix paragraph**.

Distribution by syntactic context The matrix is for organizing claims and subsection order; the citation short-list remains the source of quotation candidates. The prose should work through the following contexts in order, using the matrix rather than treating all environments as equivalent evidence.

Finite and main-clause uses Start with ordinary finite predication. This is where Form I is clearest, even though some lexical pairs still show real Form II matrix tokens.

Imperatives and directives Use imperatives and directives to reinforce the ordinary clause-force profile of Form I, while noting that some lexical pairs still show marked Form II directive material.

Negative clauses Negative clauses belong in the argument, but they are **not** a single diagnostic. The prose should say that negative environments matter, not that Form II simply equals negation.

Dependent temporal clauses with *ciangin* This is one of the strongest places to show Form II in clearly dependent syntax. It should be one of the central distributional subsections.

Temporal and nominal *ni-in* contexts Use *ni-in* as a second temporal construction so the grammar does not make *ciangin* carry the whole dependent-clause argument.

Clause-linking with *kipan* This subsection is especially important for pairs such as *nusia ~ nusiat*, where the best Form II evidence is constructionally bound and source-linking rather than a neat finite contrast.

Purposive *nadingin* Purposive or irrealis-heavy *ding / nadingin* clauses are one of the clearest places where Form II becomes prominent across several promoted pairs.

Nominalized *-na* Nominalized material should be discussed directly, but with an explicit filter against lexicalized nouns and compounds.

Attributive and relative *mi* contexts These contexts belong with the broader non-final distribution. They matter, but they should not be turned into a mechanical rule.

Possessed and genitive attributive contexts This section should stay compact and should probably center on *nei ~ neih*, since that pair gives the clearest evidence here.

Modal and ability uses This subsection should explicitly center on *thei ~ theih*, since the pair is real but constructionally special.

Quotative and say-complement contexts Discuss this environment mainly to explain why functional material such as *ci ~ cih* should not be merged blindly into the lexical-verb showcase table.

Derived, causative, compound, and lexicalized material This should be an explicit filter section, not a positive-evidence section. The grammar needs to show why *-sak* material, compounds, lexicalized families, and review-bucket rows cannot simply be counted as ordinary stem evidence.

Core showcase pairs The core pair subsection should remain narrow and should illustrate the system with the strongest three pairs:

- *mu ~ muh*
- *ne ~ nek*
- *nei ~ neih*

These pairs should do the main pedagogical work for the Form I / Form II contrast.

This should become the **small core showcase table**, not the full promoted inventory.

Promoted caveated pairs The next section should move to the broader but still promoted inventory:

- *za ~ zak*
- *pia ~ piak*
- *nusia ~ nusiak*
- *bia ~ biak*
- *thei ~ theih*
- *piang ~ pian*
- *zui ~ zuih*
- *khial ~ khialh*
- *kia ~ kiak*
- *sawlkhia ~ sawlkhiat*

Each pair should get a short paragraph or table note answering two questions:

1. **What does the evidence positively show?**
2. **What is the specific caveat?**

The point is not to collapse them into one generic “caveated examples” bucket, but to say what kind of Form II evidence each pair contributes.

This should likely become the **larger promoted-pair inventory table**, with short editorial notes rather than long prose for every row.

Difficult but grammatically important pairs This section should keep the difficult cases in the argument rather than silently dropping them:

- *ngai ~ ngaih*
- *pua ~ puak*
- *pai ~ paih*
- *tua ~ tuah*
- *tua ~ tuak*

These are not simply rejected. They matter because they show lexical-family contamination, shared-base problems, one-sided evidence, and analyzer overgeneration.

One-sided Bible attestations and questionnaire controls This section should separate two things that were too easily blurred in earlier drafts:

1. **One-sided or constructionally skewed lexical verbs** such as *bawl ~ bawlh*, *dipkua ~ dipkuat*, *gen ~ genh*, *hawlkhia ~ hawlkhiat*, *husia ~ husiat*, *kho ~ khoh*, *kido ~ kidot*, *lua ~ luah*, *tu ~ tuh*, *tuahpha ~ tuahphat*, and *vial ~ vialh*.
2. **Same-form questionnaire controls** such as *dawn ~ dawn*, *hong ~ hong*, *om ~ om*, *ci ~ ci*, *hi ~ hi*, *bawl ~ bawl*, *zui ~ zui*, *pai ~ pai*, and the other same-form rows now tracked in the lexical inventory.

The prose should say clearly that same-form questionnaire rows are useful controls, but they are not overt alternating pairs in the Bible layer.

These rows are **not** discarded. They should stay visible in a coverage table because the grammar needs to account for verbs flagged by the literature, questionnaire, analyzer inventory, and Bible audit even when only one side is cleanly attested in the current Bible layer.

Rejected/non-verbal/analyzer-noise cases This section should explain why some apparent pairs stay blocked:

- nouns and nominal compounds;
- lexicalized or compound families;
- derivational *-sak* material;
- homophones and shared-base contamination;
- category mismatches;
- analyzer overgeneration.

Representative blocked rows should include:

- *keu ~ keuh*
- *khai ~ khaih*
- *sia ~ siah*
- *tan ~ tanh*
- *mual ~ mualh*
- *sum ~ sumh*
- *thu ~ thuh*
- *lampi ~ lampih*
- *khua ~ khuat*
- *gamla ~ gamlat*

How the evidence files should be used The final prose should keep the current evidence layers distinct:

Writing order for the eventual section The actual grammar section should be drafted in this order:

1. **System-wide syntactic distribution**
2. **Best-attested showcase pairs**
3. **Promoted and difficult pair-by-pair discussion**
4. **One-sided / same-form / functional coverage table**
5. **Blocked or analyzer-noise appendix paragraph**

That is the architecture this section should now support.

Next prose draft The next commit should create a separate prose draft file rather than overwrite this planning file, probably at the present section.

That draft should be organized as:

1. **System-wide syntactic distribution**
2. **Core showcase examples**
3. **Promoted-pair inventory**
4. **Pair-by-pair notes for promoted and difficult pairs**
5. **One-sided / same-form / functional coverage table**
6. **Blocked/noise appendix paragraph**

3.2 Verb paradigms

A full discussion of verbal paradigms is not yet included in this draft.

3.3 Prefix / agreement

3.3.1 Agreement versus possession routing

The first safe prefix/agreement claim is a routing contrast. Before verbs, the shared pronominal prefix family may be routed as agreement; before nouns, the same family may be routed as possession.

Kanei and *kainn* are the core pair for that contrast. *Kanei* keeps the prefix family on a verbal host, while *kainn* keeps it on a nominal host. the current workflow is the key regression control here, because it explicitly requires verb-side AGR glossing to stay distinct from noun-side POSS glossing.

That is enough for the first print-facing claim. The slice does not need to resolve every larger prefix question before stating that host type already controls a safe agreement-versus-possession routing contrast in the current checked evidence.

3.3.2 Agreement anchor: *kanei*

Kanei is the clearest verbal agreement anchor in the section. The evidence table marks it as the main AGR-side row, and the current workflow protects the glossing as *ka-nei* / *ISG-have*.

The grammar claim here is deliberately limited. At the current slice maturity level, *kanei* supports only the routing statement that the shared prefix family can surface as verbal agreement before a verb host. This is strong enough for a narrow section, but still smaller than a full agreement chapter or a full prefix paradigm.

3.3.3 Possessive anchor: *kainn*

Kainn is the clearest possessive-routing anchor in the section. The evidence table marks it as the nominal counterpart to *kanei*, and the current workflow protects the glossing as *ka-inn* / *ISG.POSS-house*.

The grammar claim again stays small. At the current slice maturity level, *kainn* supports the routing statement that the same prefix family can be analyzed as possessive before a noun host. This is enough to justify a first print-facing contrast without pretending that the project already has a full possession chapter or a full possessor-syntax account.

3.3.4 Why this is not just pronouns again

The completed pronouns/clusivity section already handles independent pronouns, clusivity, and the broader pronoun paradigm through background notes.

This slice is doing something narrower. It is about prefix routing across verbal and nominal hosts, not about reopening the independent-pronoun paradigm. That is why *kanei* and *kainn* are better first anchors here than *ipai*, *ko*, *ei*, or any broader person-paradigm table.

3.3.5 Boundary material

The rest of the candidate section stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

ainn stays outside because the broader *a-* family overlaps with verbal agreement, relativizer-like material, and other domains. It is useful boundary evidence, but not the first clean routing anchor.

ipai stays outside because inclusive/exclusive *i-* material belongs first to the completed pronouns/clusivity section rather than to this first routing slice.

hongmu and *kongmu* stay outside because object-prefix or inverse-like material still needs a later dedicated sub-scope with tighter directional and inverse controls.

kipan stays outside because *ki-* reflexive or middle material remains boundary-only between prefix/agreement and derivation/valency.

Apostrophe possession and broader possessor syntax also stay outside because this is not a full possession chapter.

3.3.6 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest prefix/agreement claim is that Tedim has checked evidence for routing a shared pronominal prefix family differently by host type: *kanei* supports verbal agreement routing, while *kainn* supports nominal possessive routing.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full agreement chapter, smaller than a full possession chapter, smaller than a full object-prefix or inverse chapter, and smaller than a rewritten pronoun section.

3.3.7 Recommended next step

This section now properly proceeds to prefix/agreement background notes rather than to a dictionary slice, because it is a routing/analysis section rather than a lexical headword section.

3.4 Transitivity

3.4.1 Clean intransitive anchor: *sih*

sih is the clean intransitive anchor for the first slice. The controlled form and gloss/function are *sih* / *die*.

The claim stays narrow. the checked evidence tables and background notes treat *sih* as the safest current intransitive anchor because it is a simple ABS-led event row that does not immediately force derivation/valency, prefix/agreement, or case-marking analysis into the first print-facing claim.

3.4.2 Supporting intransitive row: *suak*

suak is supporting intransitive evidence rather than the sole anchor. The controlled form and gloss/function are *suak* / *become*.

That makes *suak* useful as a second row for the intransitive side of the contrast. It supports a narrow change-of-state intransitive reading without forcing the slice to generalize over the whole report-level intransitive inventory.

3.4.3 Clean transitive anchor: *hawl*

hawl is the clean transitive anchor for the first slice. The controlled form and gloss/function are *hawl* / *seek*.

The claim here also stays narrow. *hawl* is the safest current transitive anchor because it gives the section a simple transitive event row without leaning on derivation-heavy material such as *piangsak* or stem-family material such as *ngai* / *ngaih*. The report percentages in background review material are useful discovery evidence, but they are not treated here as categorical proof.

3.4.4 Supporting transitive row: *en*

en is supporting transitive evidence rather than the leading transitive claim. The controlled form and gloss/function are *en* / *look.at*.

That makes *en* useful as secondary support for the transitive side of the slice. It helps confirm the narrow contrast, but lower counts and perception-verb semantics make it weaker than *hawl* as a chapter-leading anchor.

3.4.5 Why ambitransitive/labile material is not yet the first slice

mu / *muh* remains visible boundary evidence for alternation or labile-looking behavior. It matters because it shows that the transitivity report is not exhausted by a clean binary class split.

It stays outside the first print-facing claim, however, because *mu* / *muh* overlaps directly with Form I / Form II stem alternation.

3.4.6 Boundary material

The following stay outside the first grammar slice:

- *mu / muh*
- *za / zak*
- *nei / neih*
- *ngai / ngaih*
- *piangsak*
- *pia*
- *gen*
- *tom*
- *hong*
- *ki*
- *dawt*
- *bei*
- *pia(k)sak*
- case-dominated rows
- derivation-heavy rows
- prefix/agreement-heavy rows
- analyzer-noisy, lexicalized, report-only, or whole-system verb-class claims

piangsak remains outside because it is derivation/valency-heavy and lexicalized-looking. *pia*, *gen*, and *tom* remain outside because they are dominated by broader case-marking and argument-structure interpretation. *hong* and *ki* remain outside because their report behavior is too mixed for the first clean intransitive claim. *dawt*, *bei*, and *pia(k)sak* remain outside because they are too thin, too noisy, or too report-bound for the first print-facing contrast.

3.4.7 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest transitivity claim is that Tedim has checked evidence for a narrow intransitive/transitive contrast, with *sih* and *suak* supporting the intransitive side and *hawl*, with secondary support from *en*, supporting the transitive side.

Alternation, labile behavior, stem alternation, derivation/valency, prefix/agreement, case-marking, and whole-system verb-class claims remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

3.4.8 Recommended next step

3.5 VP structure / suffix stacking

3.5.1 Baseline: completed single-suffix sections

The section starts from two completed single-suffix baselines that are already owned elsewhere.

bawlzo remains the compact V+ASPECT baseline already owned by the TAM section. It shows that the repository already has a stable completive anchor, but it should be used here only as baseline evidence rather than reopened as new VP-structure prose.

pokhia remains the compact V+DIR baseline already owned by the directionals section. It shows that the repository already has a stable post-stem directional anchor, but it should be used here only as baseline evidence rather than widened into a new VP-slot claim.

These baseline rows matter because the first VP slice should not redescribe already-completed sections. Their role here is only to show that compact single-suffix material is already controlled before a multi-suffix claim is added.

3.5.2 First stacking anchor: aspect plus irrealis

bawlzoding is the central first-slice stack. The checked evidence marks it as *print_usable_with_caveat*, and the current workflow already keeps it visible as aspect-plus-modal regression evidence.

The safe print claim is deliberately narrow. *bawlzoding* supports the ordering observation:

verb stem + completive/aspectual material + irrealis/modal material

In other words, the current slice supports a small VP-structure claim that aspectual material can precede irrealis/modal material inside a multi-suffix verbal complex.

For the present section, that means reading *bawlzoding* as a constructional stack rather than over-trusting every analyzer label on the row. The current analyzer gloss is noisy (make-south-IRR), so the slice should not pretend that the middle gloss is already a perfect semantic label. The point of the row is its suffix-stacking evidence: the repository already has a regression-backed form in which a verbal stem is followed by completive/aspectual material and then by irrealis/modal material.

This is enough for a first grammar slice, but not enough for a full VP slot template. The present section therefore treats *bawlzoding* as the clearest current anchor for aspect plus irrealis stacking and stops there.

3.5.3 Boundary and deferred stacks

The rest of the visible stacks remain outside the first core slice because each one is dominated by another section boundary.

khia-ta is useful boundary evidence because it shows real TAM/directional overlap, but it is not the first-slice core. The completed TAM and directionals sections already keep this row visible as overlap evidence, and this slice should not reopen either section through that row.

ciahsakkik, *bawlsakthei*, and *paikhiatsak* are real multi-suffix complexes, but they are derivation/valency-heavy stacks. Once *-sak* and other valency-changing material become central, the next section boundary is derivation/valency rather than narrow VP stacking. These rows therefore stay deferred until the derivation/valency section is explicitly selected.

khiathei ding om lo is also real overlap evidence, but it is TAM-negation overlap rather than a clean first VP-stack anchor. The completed negation and TAM sections already control that territory, so it should not be promoted as the model for core VP-stacking prose.

dingin remains clause-bound irrealis or subordination material. It is important because it shows how quickly visible verbal stacking can turn into clause-linkage evidence, but it should wait for a subordination section rather than being promoted here as simple VP suffix stacking.

3.5.4 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest VP-structure claim is that Tedim permits at least some multi-suffix verbal complexes in which aspectual material precedes irrealis/modal material, with *bawlzoding* as the clearest current anchor.

That claim stays deliberately smaller than a full slot template. It does not claim that every visible stack in the reports belongs to one solved VP order, and it does not reopen completed TAM, directional, negation, sentence-final, or relator/postposition sections.

3.5.5 Recommended next step

After this grammar slice, the section can move to background notes without forcing an ordinary dictionary slice, because the safe first-slice claim is constructional rather than lexical.

The next substantive section after this narrow constructional slice should therefore be derivation/valency candidate scoping rather than a broader VP rewrite.

3.6 TAM / aspect / modal

3.6.1 Experiential and habitual anchors

Paingei (*pai-ngei* → *go-EXP*) is the current experiential anchor. It supports the narrow claim that *-ngei* can mark experiential meaning such as ‘have V-ed before’ when it stays tied to a compact verbal host.

Neigige (*nei-gige* → *have-HAB*) is the current habitual anchor. It supports a modest print claim that *-gige* can mark habitual or regularly repeated action.

Paizel (*pai-zel* → *go-HAB.CONT*) is the current habitual-continuative anchor. It is usable, but it borders broader continuative aspect and should stay construction-controlled. The first TAM slice should therefore keep *-zel* tied to compact anchors such as *paizel* rather than turning every continuative-looking or lexicalized *zel* sequence into TAM evidence.

3.6.2 Compact aspectual anchors

Kilawmta (*ki-lawm-ta* → *REFL-worthy-PFV*) is the current compact perfective anchor. It supports a modest completed-event reading for *-ta*, but only with sentence-final overlap caveat. The slice relies on compact suffixed verbs, not bare *ta*, and it keeps sentence-final overlap material such as *mangngilh ta hi* outside the core TAM evidence.

Bawlzo (*bawl-zo* → *make-COMPL*) is the current compact completive anchor. It supports a modest ‘finish V-ing’ or completive reading for *-zo*, but only with the bare-*zo* and sentence-final overlap caveat kept explicit. The slice therefore treats *bawlzo* as usable compact evidence while refusing to turn bare *zo* into default TAM proof.

Hongpaikik (*hong-pai-kik* → *3→I-go-ITER*) is the current iterative anchor. It is usable as iterative or ‘again’ evidence, but it should not become a motion/return chapter. The first slice keeps *-kik* narrow and construction-backed rather than expanding it into every return- or motion-flavored verbal sequence.

3.6.3 Compact modal anchors

Omding (*om-ding* → *exist-IRR*) is the current compact *-ding* anchor. It supports a narrow irrealis / future / modal claim, but only with the explicit *dingin* and clause-bound caveat. *Dingin* and other clause-bound *-ding* material stay outside the starting section, so *omding* remains the safer anchor than report-style purposive or clause-linking material.

Bawlthei (*bawl-thei* → *make-ABIL*) is the current compact abilitative anchor. It supports a narrow ‘can / be able’ reading for *-thei*, but only with the negation/irrealis-stack caveat kept explicit. Negative-modal strings such as *khiathei ding om lo* remain overlap controls rather than core evidence for this first slice.

3.6.4 Deferred and overlap material

The following items remain out of this first grammar slice:

- *pailai*, because *-lai* still overlaps lexical *lai* / *go-midst* material and is not yet a clean prospective anchor;
- *dingin* and other clause-bound *-ding* material;
- negative modal stacks such as *khiathei ding om lo*;
- sentence-final overlap such as *mangngilh ta hi*;
- directional/TAM stacking such as *khia-ta*;
- broader VP-slot stacks such as *bawlzoding* and *bawlsakthei*;

- report-summary items such as *-nawn* and *-khin* until cleaner anchors are selected.

These forms stay visible as overlap or deferred controls, but they do not belong to the first compact TAM grammar slice.

3.6.5 Recommended next step

Broad TAM rewrite work remains out of scope.

3.7 Directionals

3.7.1 Directionals in outline

The current checked section supports a narrow generalization. Directionals are visible here as suffixed verbal or verbal-derived forms in the checked evidence. The clearest first anchors are *pokhia*, *nawhkhia*, *kilaktoh*, *piasawn*, and *paisuk*. Nominalized forms such as *hotkhiatna* and *kahtohna* are useful boundary evidence but are not identical to finite directional verbs. *-toh* requires an explicit comitative/accompany warning because *paitoh* is blocked as lexicalized *go-accompany*. *-lam* remains direction/side/manner boundary material rather than a clean simple verbal suffix in the current evidence. *-lut*, *-phei*, *-cip*, and *-tang* remain deferred or not well-supported.

3.7.2 Outward *-khia*

Genesis 2:5 supplies the cleanest current outward anchor:

- (3.71) *po-khìa*
grow-out
'grew' (Genesis 2:5)

Pokhia is the cleanest current outward *-khia* anchor. It supports a modest print claim that *-khia* can mark outward motion or direction.

That claim must stay narrow. The row does **not** license raw *khia* harvesting or a claim that every orthographic *khia* sequence is directional evidence.

3.7.3 Away *-khiat* and nominalized *-khiat-na*

Deuteronomy 9:4 supplies the current away anchor:

- (3.72) *nawh-khiat*
hurry-away
'cast them out' (Deuteronomy 9:4)

Nawhkhia is the current compact away *-khiat* anchor. It is accepted with caveat because the export still labels the selected lemma/POS as *nawh* / *N*. The example is therefore usable as construction-backed away evidence with an analyzer label caution, not as an uncomplicated finite-verb showcase.

Future prose should keep *-khiat* construction-controlled rather than treating every *...khiat* token as the same directional claim.

Exodus 14:13 then keeps nominalized boundary material visible:

- (3.73) *hot-khiat-ná*
save-away-NMLZ
'salvation' (Exodus 14:13)

Hotkhiatna keeps *-khiat-na* visible in the section. It is nominalized boundary material and should not be treated as identical to a finite directional predicate.

3.7.4 Upward *-toh* and comitative/accompany overlap

Numbers 9:17 supplies the current upward anchor:

- (3.74) *kī-lāk-tòh*
REFL-take-UP
'was taken up' (Numbers 9:17)

Kilaktoh is the current upward *-toh* anchor. It is usable only with the section's polysemy caveat: this row supports upward *-toh*, but it does not license a raw equation of *-toh* = *UP*.

Blocked control:

paitoh

Paitoh is blocked as comitative/accompany material. The analyzer tests treat it as lexicalized *go-accompany*, so the present grammar slice must not imply that every *-toh* token is upward-directional evidence. Upward *-toh* examples should therefore be paired with this explicit caveat.

Deuteronomy 32:50 also keeps nominalized *-toh-na* material visible:

- (3.75) *kàh-tòh-ná*
climb-up-NMLZ
'the mount whither thou goest up' / 'going up' (Deuteronomy 32:50)

Kahtohna keeps *-toh-na* visible, but it is nominalized boundary material rather than a simple finite directional predicate.

3.7.5 Direction/side/manner *-lam*

Genesis 30:9 keeps *-lam* visible:

- (3.76) *tawp-lam*
end-TOWARD
'left off' / 'at the end' (Genesis 30:9)

Tawplam keeps *-lam* visible, but the export profile remains nominal (*tawp* / *N*). The safest present analysis is therefore direction/side/manner boundary material rather than a clean verbal directional suffix.

This row should not be used to turn every *-lam* form into a simple verbal directional.

3.7.6 Toward *-sawn*

Ezra 9:9 supplies the current cautious toward row:

- (3.77) *pía-sàwn*
give-toward
'give us' / 'extend to us' (Ezra 9:9)

Piasawn is the current cautious toward *-sawn* row. It is more useful than kinship-heavy or nominal-looking rows for this section, but it still should stay construction-controlled. The current slice should not generalize from lexicalized, continuative-looking, or kinship-heavy *-sawn* material.

3.7.7 Downward -suk

Genesis 11:5 supplies the first corpus-backed downward row:

- (3.78) *pái-sùk*
go-DOWN
'came down' (Genesis 11:5)

Paisuk gives the section a corpus-backed downward -suk row. Analyzer tests also support -suk, but print prose should rely on corpus-backed checked examples rather than analyzer inventory alone.

3.7.8 Deferred forms: -lut, -phei, -cip, -tang

Several forms remain visible only as deferred or not well-supported controls in this first slice:

- *uilut* keeps -lut visible but is not yet a clean print-safe inward anchor;
- *paiphei* keeps -phei visible, but the current export gloss *go-enter* does not justify a clean horizontal claim;
- *cip* remains lexical or analyzer-noise material rather than directional down evidence;
- *tang* remains lexical or analyzer-noise material rather than endpoint-directional evidence.

These forms remain deferred or not well-supported in this slice. They should not be promoted without cleaner analyzer-backed corpus rows.

3.7.9 Editorial summary

This slice safely supports seven modest claims: -khia is usable as outward evidence, anchored by *pokhia*; -khiat is usable as away evidence, anchored by *nawhkhia*, with -khiat-na boundary material from *hotkhiatna*; -toh is usable as upward evidence, anchored by *kilaktah*, but only with the *paitoh* comitative/accompany caveat; -toh-na remains visible through *kahtohna* as nominalized boundary material; -lam remains direction/side/manner boundary material; -sawn remains cautious toward evidence through *piasawn*; and -suk is now corpus-backed downward evidence through *paisuk*.

What remains deferred is equally important: raw generated-report counts, raw suffix harvesting, *paitoh* as upward -toh, nominalized -na forms as equivalent to finite directional verbs, -lut, -phei, -cip, and -tang as well-supported directionals, and broad TAM or VP-slot prose. Broad TAM, chrestomathy, Mizo/lus, and other Kuki-Chin language work remain deferred.

Dictionary and background work have not yet begun.

3.8 Derivation / valency

3.8.1 Causative -sak

paisak is the safest causative anchor for the first print-facing derivation / valency claim. The checked evidence marks it as the main future -sak causative anchor, and background review material already lists it among the common -sak forms.

The safe grammar claim is deliberately narrow. The current evidence supports a productive Form I plus -sak causative pattern, with *paisak* as the checked row that shows the pattern most cleanly. the current workflow protects that contrast explicitly by requiring *paisak* to gloss as *go-CAUS* rather than as a benefactive or lexicalized exception.

That is enough for the first core claim. The slice does not need to generalize over every -sak form in the reports before saying that a productive causative use is visible.

3.8.2 Benefactive / applicative-like -sak

muhsak is the safest benefactive or applicative-like split row in the current evidence. The checked evidence keeps it distinct from the plain causative line, and the current workflow protects that distinction by requiring Form II

plus *-sak* rows to keep the *.II* marker and a *BENF* gloss.

The print claim here also stays narrow. The current evidence supports keeping Form II plus *-sak* distinct from the plain causative line in the checked evidence, with *muhsak* as the clearest first-row anchor. The literature and morpheme files justify describing this as benefactive or applicative-like material, but the slice should not pretend that every higher-level label choice is already settled.

This is why *muhsak* belongs in the first slice even though it is more caveated than *paisak*. It is the clearest compact row showing that the *-sak* domain is not exhausted by a simple causative paraphrase.

3.8.3 Editorial treatment of the *-sak* split

The grammar can therefore treat the *paisak* versus *muhsak* contrast as a controlled split in the first section. The evidence is strong enough to keep Form I plus *-sak* and Form II plus *-sak* apart in the editorial layer.

At the same time, the slice should keep open the higher-level question of whether this contrast is best described as two readings of one suffix or two editorial subsections of the same suffixal domain.

This first slice therefore adopts a practical editorial solution rather than a maximal theoretical one. It prints the causative and benefactive/applicative-like uses as separate controlled subsections while leaving open whether a later chapter should collapse them back into one suffix with two readings.

3.8.4 Boundary material

The rest of the candidate section remains outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

paipih stays outside the first grammar slice because *-pih* still carries applicative, comitative, associative, and benefactive uncertainty. *mipih* stays outside because it is nominal or lexicalized *pih* boundary material rather than a clean verbal anchor.

kisep and *kigen* stay outside because *ki-* still needs a separate reflexive, middle, and passive-like treatment, and because the section must keep prefix/agreement boundary control explicit through background notes and the current workflow.

ciahsakkik, *bawlsakthei*, and *paikhiatsak* stay outside because they are derivation-heavy stacks interacting respectively with aspect, modal, and directional material. Those rows remain visible through background notes, background notes, background notes, and the current workflow, but they are not the first core derivation anchor.

piangsak stays outside because it is lexicalized or transitivity-adjacent rather than a clean productive *-sak* anchor.

3.8.5 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest derivation / valency claim is that Tedim has checked evidence for a productive *-sak* domain, with *paisak* supporting a causative use and *muhsak* supporting a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full derivation chapter, smaller than a full valency chapter, and smaller than a full verbal morphology chapter. It does not settle the whole *-pih* system, the whole *ki-* system, derivation-heavy stacking, or transitivity as a separate domain.

3.8.6 Recommended next step

3.9 Nominalization

3.9.1 Deverbal nominalization with *-na*

-na is the safest current nominalization anchor in the section. The evidence table marks it as the main future print-facing row, and the report, source map, and skeleton all converge on it as the primary productive deverbal nominalizer.

The grammar claim here is deliberately limited. At the current slice maturity level, the safe print-facing row is *bawl-na*, with the segmentation *bawl-na* and the controlled gloss *make-NMLZ / making, creation*. That is enough to support a narrow claim for productive deverbal action or result nominalization without broadening into a full nominalization chapter.

3.9.2 Why *-pa* and *-mi* are not yet the first slice

Agentive or person-head nominalization evidence also exists in the checked evidence, especially through *bawlpa* and *hong pai mi*.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because *-pa* has lexicalized or title-like boundary rows such as *kumpipa* and *Topa*, while *-mi* still overlaps with person-head and relative-clause analysis. The section is stronger if it keeps *-pa* and *-mi* visible but secondary rather than forcing them into the first nominalization slice before those lexical and clausal boundaries are better settled.

3.9.3 Why nominalized relatives are not yet the first slice

Nominalized relative or clause-derived nominal evidence also exists in the checked evidence, especially through *omna*.

That row stays outside the first print-facing claim because it still belongs partly to clause linkage and relative-clause analysis. The current evidence can safely preserve *omna* as candidate-layer evidence without pretending that the first nominalization slice should already resolve the nominalization versus relative-clause boundary.

3.9.4 Why nominalization plus case is not yet the first slice

Nominalization-plus-case evidence also exists in the boundary layer, especially through *muhna-ah*.

That row stays outside the first print-facing claim because it belongs partly to case marking and clause-linkage boundaries. It is important evidence for later section coordination, but it should not lead the first nominalization slice.

3.9.5 Boundary material

The rest of the nominalization section stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

bawlpa stays outside because agentive *-pa* still has to be separated from lexicalized and title-like rows.

hong pai mi stays outside because person-head *-mi* still overlaps with relative-clause analysis.

omna stays outside because nominalized relatives remain shared with clause linkage.

muhna-ah stays outside because nominalization plus case routing remains shared with case marking.

kumpipa and *Topa* stay outside because lexicalized or title-like *-pa* rows should not be mistaken for the cleanest productive anchor.

a bawl mi and similar human-head relative rows stay outside because they still sit between nominalization, relative clauses, and prefix/agreement questions.

bare *na* stays outside because it is an analyzer-noisy surface form.

report-only counts stay outside because attestation by itself does not make a row safe for the first print-facing claim.

Any broad nominalization chapter claim stays outside because this section is not yet ready to generalize from one safe deverbal nominalizer to the whole nominalization system.

3.9.6 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest nominalization claim is that Tedim has checked evidence for productive deverbal nominalization with *-na*, with *bawl^{na}* / *bawl-na* as the clearest current anchor. Agentive *-pa*, person-head *-mi*, nominalized relatives, and nominalization-plus-case rows remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full nominalization chapter, smaller than a full derivation chapter, smaller than a full relative-clause chapter, and smaller than a full case-routing chapter.

3.9.7 Recommended next step

This section now properly proceeds to nominalization background notes rather than to a dictionary slice, because this is a constructional or morphological section and the lexical treatment of *-pa*, *-mi*, and lexicalized forms remains unsettled.

3.10 Clause linkage

3.10.1 Temporal subordination: *ciangin*

Ciangin is the safest current subordination anchor in the section. The evidence table marks it as the main future print-facing row, and the reports plus literature review converge on it as the clearest temporal subordinator.

The grammar claim here is deliberately limited. At the current slice maturity level, the safe print-facing row is *tua ciangin*, with the segmentation *ciang-in* kept visible where useful. That is enough to support a narrow temporal subordination claim without broadening into a full complex-sentence chapter or a full inventory of all clause-linkage constructions.

3.10.2 Clause-bound purposive / irrealis overlap: *dingin*

Dingin is relevant to clause linkage because the reports support purposive or clause-bound irrealis use, but it remains partly shared with TAM. The checked evidence is therefore right to keep it explicit while refusing to let it lead the first slice.

The grammar claim stays cautious on purpose. At the current slice maturity level, *dingin* is visible only as a caveated overlap row: it helps show that clause linkage interacts with purposive or irrealis marking, but it does not yet justify a broader clause-linkage or TAM rewrite.

3.10.3 Why switch reference is not yet the first slice

Switch-reference evidence exists in the checked evidence, especially through *VERB-in* with *ngenin* as the anchor example and through *ahih ciangin* as the clearest different-subject construction.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because the converb, subordinator, and switch-reference analysis remains theoretically unsettled. The current evidence can safely preserve them as candidate-layer evidence without pretending that the first clause-linkage slice should already be a switch-reference chapter.

3.10.4 Why relative clauses are not yet the first slice

Relative-clause evidence also exists in the checked evidence, especially through *a bawl mi* and *omna*.

Those rows stay outside the first print-facing claim because relative clauses still interact with prefix/agreement, nominalization, and case-routing questions. The section is stronger if it keeps relative clauses visible but secondary rather than forcing them into the first clause-linkage slice before those boundaries are better settled.

3.10.5 Boundary material

The rest of the clause-linkage section stays outside the first grammar slice because each row is still dominated by another unresolved boundary.

VERB-in and *ngenin* stay outside because same-subject chaining still sits on the boundary between converbial chaining, subordination, and switch-reference analysis.

ahih ciangin stays outside because different-subject linkage still overlaps with temporal subordination and pronominal boundary questions.

a bawl mi and *omna* stay outside because relative clauses still interact with prefix/agreement and nominalization.

muhna-ah stays outside because nominalized relative-plus-case material belongs to a later nominalization and case-routing treatment.

leh stays outside because sentence-final-particle, coordinator, and subordinator analyses still overlap there.

hangin and *bangin* stay outside because they remain broader report-inventory rows rather than the first safe print anchor.

report-only relative-clause counts involving *a-* also stay outside because they do not yet separate relativizer behavior cleanly from broader prefix/agreement material.

Any broad complex-sentence chapter claim stays outside because this section is not yet ready to generalize from one safe subordination anchor to the whole clause-linkage system.

3.10.6 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest clause-linkage claim is that Tedim has checked evidence for temporal subordination, with *ciangin* as the clearest current anchor. *Dingin* is visible as a caveated purposive or clause-bound irrealis overlap row, but switch reference and relative clauses remain candidate-layer material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full complex-sentence chapter, smaller than a full switch-reference chapter, and smaller than a full relative-clause chapter.

3.10.7 Recommended next step

This section now properly proceeds to clause-linkage background notes rather than to a dictionary slice, because it is a constructional or clausal section rather than a lexical-headword section.

4 Clause type, discourse-facing material, and expressive morphology

4.1 Negation

4.1.1 Overview of the negation system

The literature and the Bible corpus agree on one central point: Tedim negation cannot be reduced to *lo* alone. Henderson foregrounds *-kei*, including prohibitive uses, while Zam Ngaih Cing explicitly describes a contrast between *-kei* and *-lou/-loun* and links the latter to stem-sensitive or dependent environments (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). The safest summary is therefore not “Tedim negation = *lo*”, but rather that the present corpus supports a three-part treatment: ordinary clause-level negation with *lo*, dependent or derived negation with *loh*, and *kei* as a central negator in prohibitives and many irrealis-heavy or directive contexts.

4.1.2 Clause-level negation with *lo*

Lo is the safest place to start because it is the clearest ordinary clause-level negator in the Bible corpus. It appears in straightforward negative predicates such as *thusim lo hi*, *nei lo hi*, *om lo hi*, and in many future or modal combinations such as *V lo ding*. That does not make it the whole negation system, but it does make it the most transparent starting point.

- (4.79) *àhìh* *hàng-ìn* *Kain lè àmà* *piak-ná* *thusim lò* *hì.* *Túa àhìh*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG KAIN and 3SG.POSS give.to-NMLZ parable NEG DECL DIST be.3SG.REL
ciang-ìn *Kain hèh* *màhmàh à,* *à* *mái sía* *hì.*
then-ERG KAIN anger very 3SG 3SG face evil DECL

‘but unto Cain and to his offering he had not respect. And Cain was very wroth, and his countenance fell.’ (Genesis 4:5)

Genesis 4:5 is a good central example because it shows exactly the clause type a reader expects from a first negation section: a verbal predicate followed by *lo* and the clause-final declarative material. Genesis 11:30 *ta nei lo hi* is equally useful in a more compact predicative clause, and existential patterns such as *om lo hi* belong in the same zone.

V lo uh is a real and common surface string, but it is not automatically prohibitive. Genesis 2:25 *maizum lo uh hi* means “they were not ashamed” and is simply an ordinary plural negative predicate. Similar plural negatives occur elsewhere with no imperative force. It is better treated as an ordinary clausal negative pattern than as the defining prohibitive construction.

4.1.3 Dependent and derived negation with *loh*

Loh should not be treated as a random spelling variant of *lo*. In the current Bible corpus it clusters in dependent, purposive, and derived environments such as ... *loh dinga*, ... *loh dingin*, and ... *loh nadingin*. The safest label is therefore something like “dependent or derived negative form”, not just “another way to spell *lo*”.

- (4.80) *Àmàh in, nà guak-tāng-à nà òm-ná kua in hòng gēn àhì hìam? Nà*
 3SG.PRO ERG 2SG bare-body-LOC 2SG exist-NMLZ who ERG 3→1 speak be.3SG Q 2SG
nèk lòh dīng-à kòng thupiak singgah né khá nà hì hìam” cí
 eat.II NEG-NOM IRR-LOC 1SG→3 commandment hang eat NEG.PERF 2SG DECL Q say
hì.
 DECL

‘And he said, Who told thee that thou wast naked? Hast thou eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldest not eat?’ (Genesis 3:11)

Genesis 3:11 is especially useful because *loh* is not just attached to a bare verb in isolation. It appears inside a dependent complex, *na nek loh dinga kong thupiak*, where the whole point is the commanded non-occurrence of the event. Isaiah 6:10 strengthens the same pattern by repeating *muh loh nading*, *zak loh nading*, and *theihtel loh nading* inside clearly purposive or clause-linking material. This is exactly the distribution seen again and again in the corpus: *loh* is where the Bible orthography most visibly tracks non-finite, dependent, and derived negation.

4.1.4 *kei* in prohibitives and irrealis-heavy negation

Kei is central to real prohibitives in the Bible corpus, and those prohibitives are among the cleanest manually checked negative examples available. This alone is enough to show why the negation system cannot be flattened to *lo*.

- (4.81) *Àmàh in, tangval-pà sù kèi in. Àmà tòngàh bangmah hih kèi in. Bàng*
 3SG.PRO ERG TANGVALPA tear NEG ERG 3SG.POSS on-LOC nothing PROX NEG ERG like
hàng hìam cih lèh nàng in Pasian nà zah-tàk-ná tù-in kà thèi à,
 reason Q say.NOM and 2SG.PRO ERG God 2SG fear-exact-NMLZ now-ERG 1SG know 3SG
nà tá-pà khàt nèih-sun kèima à dīng-in nà hum-cìp lòh-ná kà mú
 2SG child-male one have.II-long 1SG.self 3SG IRR-ERG 2SG fear-grip NEG-NMLZ 1SG see.I
hì” à cí hì.
 DECL 3SG say DECL

‘And he said, Lay not thine hand upon the lad, neither do thou any thing unto him: for now I know that thou fearest God, seeing thou hast not withheld thy son, thine only son from me.’ (Genesis 22:12)

Genesis 22:12 gives two clear negative imperatives in the same speech turn. Genesis 15:1 *Lau kei in*, Genesis 19:17 *Nunghei kei unla*,... *khawl kei un*, Leviticus 10:9 *ne kei un*, and Numbers 14:42 *kuanto kei un*... *do kei un* all point in the same direction: *kei* is the core prohibitive negator in the current Bible data.

The corpus also shows that *kei* is not limited to prohibitives or to first-person realis. Exodus 5:2 has both *ka thei kei hi* and *ka paisak kei ding hi*, which shows *kei* in ordinary negation and in irrealis-heavy future material. The safest print summary is therefore that *kei* is central in prohibitives and common in directive, quoted, or otherwise irrealis-heavy negation, without forcing the whole system into a rigid person-based rule.

4.1.5 Negative existence and cessative negation

Negative existence belongs with ordinary *lo*-based negation, but it deserves its own short section because it is extremely common and very readable in Bible prose. Clauses such as Genesis 11:30 *ta nei lo hi*, Genesis 37:24 *a sungah tui om lo hi*, and Genesis 39:9 *a kep tuam bangmah om lo hi* show the ordinary Tedim way of saying that something is absent, unavailable, or not possessed.

The corpus also supports a neat constructional entry for *nawn lo* “no longer, not again”. Genesis 8:12 *hong ciahkik nawn lo hi* is a clean cessative example, and Genesis 17:5 *Na min Abram hi nawn lo ding a* shows the same construction in a renamed-future environment. This material is better treated as a construction than as a new basic negator.

4.1.6 Ability and inability

The clearest treatment here is not a bare negator but the constructional pair *thei lo* / *theih loh*. The Bible shows common clause-level inability with *thei lo*, while dependent or derived negative ability is better represented by *theih loh* patterns than by the much rarer exact string *theih lo*.

- (4.82) *À khùt-tè in à sanggampa Esau' khùt bàng-in mól néi àhìh mán-in*
 3SG hand-PL ERG 3SG brother ESAU.POSS hand like-ERG hair have be.3SG.REL reason-ERG
àmàh in thei lò hì. Túa àhìh cìang-in àmàh in thù-phà pía
 3SG.PRO ERG know NEG DECL DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG 3SG.PRO ERG word-good give
dìng-in kithawi à,
 IRR-ERG hot.displeasure 3SG
 ‘And he discerned him not, because his hands were hairy, as his brother Esau’s hands: so he blessed him.’ (Genesis 27:23)

Genesis 27:23 is a compact ordinary example: *thei lo hi* means that recognition or knowledge failed to occur. Genesis 37:4 *amah hopih thei lo uh hi* shows the same pattern with an ability reading, while Exodus 33:20 *na mu thei kei ding hi* shows inability under *kei*. On the dependent side, Exodus 10:5 *muh theih loh nadingin* and Isaiah 6:10 *theihtel loh nading* show why *theih loh* must be represented directly rather than treating exact *theih lo* as the dominant form in the current corpus.

4.1.7 Negative polarity items

The Bible corpus gives clean negative-polarity material, but only after filtering. Raw exact-string counts overgenerate because *kuamah* can occur in non-pronominal strings and *bangmah* has non-NPI uses such as *tua bangmah hi-in* “likewise”. The discussion here therefore uses only manually checked examples.

- (4.83) *Àmàh khù-a-dāk kawì-kawì à, kuamah mú lò àhìh mán-in Egypt*
 3SG.PRO town-near crooked~REDUP 3SG nobody see.I NEG be.3SG.REL reason-ERG EGYPT
mipa thàt-in sehnèl sùng-àh à seel hì.
 man kill-CVB wilderness inside-LOC 3SG hide DECL
 ‘And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.’ (Exodus 2:12)

Exodus 2:12 is a good *kuamah* example because the NPI is clearly licensed by the negative predicate. *Bangmah* behaves similarly in real NPI contexts such as Genesis 22:12 *Ama tungah bangmah hih kei in* and Genesis 39:9 *bangmah om lo hi*. Those are the kinds of examples the dictionary can safely quote. What should stay out of the main prose is any claim based on raw counts alone.

4.1.8 Summary

The current evidence is strong enough for a stable negation chapter, but only if it keeps the system narrow and honest. *Lo* is the safest starting point for ordinary clause-level negation. *Loh* is a real dependent or derived negative form and should not be collapsed into accidental spelling variation. *Kei* is central in prohibitives and in many irrealis-heavy negatives, so the chapter must represent it directly rather than relegating it to a footnote.

Just as important, the description must avoid false simplicity. *V lo uh* is not the prohibitive construction, Genesis 2:25 is not a prohibitive example, and the NPI section must use filtered examples rather than raw exact-string totals. The result is a compact but linguistically honest account of the current Bible evidence.

4.2 Interrogatives

4.2.1 Interrogatives in outline

The current checked section supports a narrow generalization. Yes/no questions can be marked by clause-final *hiam*, and content questions use a WH element plus *hiam*. The present WH inventory represented in the section is *bang*, *kua*, *bangci*, and *banghangin*. Embedded question complements are visible in the background notes, but they are not yet ready for the first printed analysis.

Because this slice is controlled by the candidate-first section rather than by raw report counts, it should stay narrow. The point here is not to describe every sentence-final question marker or every surface occurrence of *hiam*, but to print only the examples that the current candidate and background notes layer already support.

4.2.2 Clause-final *hiam*

The current checked examples support clause-final *hiam* as the core yes/no pattern represented in this section. The best print anchor is Genesis 24:23, using the attested analyzer-backed clause rather than the older generated-report paraphrase.

(4.84) [REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:hiam-yes-no: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]

Nà pà inn-àh kòtè giah nàding à áwng dīng hiam
2SG father house-LOC 1PL.PRO camp PURP 3SG open IRR Q

‘Is there room in thy father’s house for us to lodge?’ (Genesis 24:23)

This printed example should replace the older report paraphrase *Inn-ah hong tum theih na hiam*. The background notes is explicit that the exported window for Genesis 24:23 is *Na pa inn-ah kote giah nading a awng ding hiam*, and that attested clause is what the section should use. The evidence table also records one export caveat: punctuation is attached to the final token in the raw analyzer window, but that punctuation artifact should not be printed as if it were part of *hiam* itself.

4.2.3 WH + *hiam* content questions

The content-question pattern in the current evidence is WH + *hiam*. The safest print-facing claim is therefore not that every WH form behaves identically, but that the present checked examples show *bang*, *kua*, *bangci*, and *banghangin* in this construction.

(4.85) *Bàng àhì hiam?*
like be.3SG Q

‘What is it?’ (Exodus 16:15)

Exodus 16:15 is the current print anchor for *bang*. The background notes keeps one export caveat explicit: the analyzer glosses *bang* here as *like*. The clause-level evidence and KJV alignment still support the ordinary what-question reading, so the example remains usable in print with that caveat recorded in the section rather than foregrounded in the example line.

(4.86) [REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:hiam-kua: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]

Hih-tè kua àhì hiam?
PROX-PL who be.3SG Q

‘Who are these?’ (Exodus 16:15)

Genesis 48:8 is the current print anchor for *kua... hiam*, and 2 Samuel 22:32 gives additional support for the same pattern (*Topa longal Pasian kua hiam*). The background notes again keeps the relevant export caveat explicit: *kua* is tagged as *NUM* in the analyzer output. That label should be treated as an export limitation rather than as evidence against the interrogative reading.

(4.87) *Bangci à hi-cí gàm-tat nà hì hiam?*
how 3SG PROX-say land-rule 2SG DECL Q
‘How have you acted thus?’ (Genesis 3:13)

Genesis 3:13 is the cleanest current *bangci* row, and it matters methodologically because it should remain visible as *bangci*, not be flattened into a generic *bang* example.

The present section also keeps Genesis 4:6 as reason-question evidence:

bang hangin na mai sia ahi hiam

This row is important because it keeps *banghangin* in the slice while also recording the segmentation caveat from the background notes. The analyzer exports the sequence as *bang | hang-in | na | mai | sia | ahi | hiam*, but the current evidence still treats the clause as curated reason-question evidence rather than as a raw *bang* hit.

4.2.4 Embedded questions

The background notes keeps Exodus 16:15 *bang hiam cih thei lo uh hi* visible as embedded-question material, but it is not promoted here as a core independent-clause *hiam* example. It should remain deferred for a later treatment of embedded questions or interrogative complementation, not folded into the first printed outline as if it were interchangeable with the main clause-final examples above.

4.2.5 Blocked false friends

The section also shows why raw *hiam* and *bang* matching would overgenerate. *Bang hang hiam cih leh* in Genesis 3:20 is a formulaic explanatory frame, not an ordinary question example. Revelation 1:16 *langnih a hiam namsau* and 2 Kings 11:11 *a hiam ciat uh* are lexical or non-interrogative *hiam* controls rather than question-particle evidence. Likewise, *bangmah* and *bangin* are bang-family false friends and should not be treated as ordinary *bang* interrogatives.

These blocked rows matter because they keep the printed claim small and accurate: the slice prints checked interrogative examples, not every surface string that happens to contain *hiam* or *bang*.

4.2.6 Deferred particles

Existing generated reports mention *maw*, *ham*, and *em*, but they remain deferred in this first section. They are not part of the core *hiam* evidence printed here, and this section does not yet build a comparison-particle analysis.

4.2.7 Editorial summary

This slice can now safely support four modest claims. First, *hiam* is the checked question marker in the current print section, with clause-final *hiam* as the core pattern represented in the accepted examples. Second, WH + *hiam* is the current content-question pattern. Third, *bang*, *kua*, *bangci*, and *banghangin* are the current checked WH forms. Fourth, embedded questions and deferred comparison particles remain outside the scope of this first printed analysis.

4.3 Sentence-final particles

4.3.1 Sentence-final particles in outline

The current checked section supports a narrow generalization. *Hi* is visible only through constructionally controlled *ahi hi* and *lo hi* rows. *Hiam* is visible only as overlap control because interrogatives are already stabilized. *Hen* has one usable optative row. *In* and *un* represent imperative material, but *in* has case-marker overlap while *un* is cleaner. *Aw* is only vocative or exclamative boundary material and is not well-supported. *Tahen*, *ta*, and *zo* remain deferred or needs-review because the export is noisy. Broad TAM remains deferred.

4.3.2 Declarative *hi* with copula overlap

Genesis 1:13 supplies the current declarative anchor:

- (4.88) *àhì hì*
 be.3SG DECL
 ‘it was’ (Genesis 1:13)

This is the current copula-plus-declarative evidence, but only with caveat. It is not a bare *hi* example. The row bundles copular *ahi* with final *hi*, so it does not license raw *hi* harvesting or a claim that every *hi* token is sentence-final declarative.

4.3.3 Negative-plus-declarative *lo hi*

Genesis 4:5 keeps one negative-plus-declarative environment visible:

- (4.89) *thusim lò hì*
 parable NEG DECL
 ‘he had not respect’ / ‘it was not accepted’ (Genesis 4:5)

This row keeps *lo hi* visible as a sentence-final environment, but it overlaps the stabilized negation section. The present slice should not reopen *lo* or build a new negation section here. It is treated as negation-overlap evidence only.

4.3.4 *Hiam* as interrogatives overlap

Deferred / overlap control:

Hihte kua ahi hiam?

Genesis 48:8 is mentioned here only as cross-reference material. *Hiam* belongs to the stabilized interrogatives section, so this sentence-final particle slice should not reopen or duplicate *hiam* analysis. The row is not a print anchor for this slice, and the quotation or punctuation noise plus the *kua* = *NUM* export caveat should remain visible rather than normalized away.

4.3.5 Optative *hen*

Genesis 1:3 supplies the current usable optative row:

- (4.90) *Khuavak òm hèn*
 light exist JUSS
 ‘Let there be light’ (Genesis 1:3)

This is the current usable optative evidence with caveat. The candidate is analyzer-backed as *om hen*, so the slice should not replace it with report-style *ta hen* wording. It also should not turn this narrow row into a broad mood chapter.

4.3.6 Imperative *in* and *un*

Genesis 6:14 keeps one singular imperative row visible:

- (4.91) *teembaw khàt bāwl in*
ark one make ERG
'Make thee an ark' (Genesis 6:14)

This keeps singular imperative *in* visible, but only with a serious case-marker and export caveat: *in* is exported as *ERG* / *FUNC*. The candidate also has *teembaw*, not report-style *lawng*. The slice should not harvest raw *in* hits and should not reopen case marking.

Psalms 100:1 supplies the cleanest current imperative anchor:

- (4.92) *ging-sàk ùn*
sound-CAUS IMP.PL
'Make a joyful noise' (Psalms 100:1)

This is the clean plural-imperative anchor. The span should stay tight so nearby *aw* material in the same verse is not absorbed, and the row should not be used to launch a full imperative paradigm.

4.3.7 *Aw* as vocative/exclamative boundary material

Boundary material:

Gam khempeuh aw

Psalms 100:1 keeps *aw* visible, but only as vocative or exclamative boundary material. The analyzer glosses *aw* as *voice* and gives *N* in *pos_span*, and the same verse also has another *aw* in *lungdamna aw*. This is therefore not settled sentence-final mood evidence, and raw *aw* hits should not be treated as sentence-final particles.

4.3.8 *Tahen*, *ta*, and *zo* deferred

Several report-visible rows remain too noisy to promote:

- *hi taken*: deferred because *tahen* is exported as *army* / *N*; the slice should not normalize fused *tahen* or split *ta hen* into a clean jussive example.
- *mangngilh ta hi*: needs-review TAM-overlap material because *ta* is exported as *child* / *FUNC*.
- *zo*: deferred because the export glosses *zo* as *south* / *N* rather than as clean completive evidence.

These rows keep report-visible material in view, but they are not well-supported as jussive, perfective, or completive evidence. Broad TAM remains deferred.

4.3.9 Editorial summary

This slice safely supports five modest claims: *ahi hi* is usable as copula-plus-declarative evidence with caveat; *thusim lo hi* is usable as negation-plus-declarative evidence with caveat; *Khuavak om hen* is usable as optative evidence with caveat; *teembaw khat bawl in* is usable as singular imperative evidence only with a case-overlap caveat; and *gingsak un* is the clean plural-imperative anchor.

What remains deferred is equally important: bare *hi* as a general declarative particle, *hiam* as new sentence-final evidence, *tahen* as a settled jussive, *aw* as a settled exclamative or mood particle, *ta* and *zo* as settled aspectual particles, broad TAM and full mood or aspect chapters, and raw generated-report counts. Broad TAM, directionals, chrestomathy, Mizo/lus, and other Kuki-Chin language work remain deferred.

Dictionary and background slices have not yet begun.

4.4 Coordinators

4.4.1 Coordinators in outline

The current checked section supports a narrow generalization. *Le* currently provides the safe NP-conjunction anchor. *Leh* is visible, but only as conditional or boundary evidence rather than as well-supported simple clause conjunction. *A* is visible only as caveated sequential-linkage boundary evidence and must not be harvested raw. *Mawh* remains deferred until a clean disjunction or alternative-question example is located. *Ahih hangin* is the current adversative connector anchor, with an internal-analysis caveat. *Ahih kei leh* is conditional-adversative boundary material, not a simple coordinator.

4.4.2 NP coordination with *le*

Genesis 1:1 supplies the clean well-supported anchor:

- (4.93) *vàn-tùng lè lèi-tùng*
sky-on and land-on
'heaven and earth' (Genesis 1:1)

This is the current safe NP-conjunction anchor. It supports a modest print claim that *le* joins noun phrases.

That claim must remain narrow. The row does **not** license broad raw *le* harvesting, and the current evidence does not treat every *le* token as coordinator evidence. A separate blocked *le* row was not created in the first pass; overgeneration is controlled here by curated selection rather than by a broad token sweep.

4.4.3 *Leh* as conditional or boundary material

Genesis 13:9 keeps *leh* visible only as warning or boundary evidence:

- (4.94) *véi-lam nà lāk lèh kèi taklam-àh kà pái dīng hì*
faint-direction 2SG among and NEG right-LOC 1SG go IRR DECL
'if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right' (Genesis 13:9)

This row keeps *leh* visible, but not as a clean simple clause-conjunction anchor. The wider English context is conditional, so future coordinator prose must not flatten conditional *leh* into a simple printed “and” analysis.

The row also carries an analyzer or export caveat: *kei* is glossed as *NEG* in the selected window even though the wider English context is “I will go.” That should be recorded as an export caveat, not used to reopen the pronouns or negation sections.

4.4.4 Sequential *a* and agreement-*a* false friends

Genesis 2:10 keeps one possible sequential-linkage window visible:

- (4.95) *luang à túa mún pàn-in gun hòng kikhen-in*
flow 3SG DIST place ABL-ERG river 3→1 separate-CVB
'and from thence it was parted' (Genesis 2:10)

This row keeps possible sequential linkage visible, but it is not well-supported as a core coordinator example. The analyzer still exports the relevant *a* as *3SG / FUNC*, so the present slice treats it as warning or boundary evidence only.

Blocked control:

a piangsak

Genesis 1:1 *a piangsak* is blocked agreement or function material, not coordinator evidence. This false-friend control prevents raw *a* harvesting from flooding the coordinator section.

4.4.5 *Mawh* deferred

The present slice does not print a positive *mawh* example.

Deferred control:

mawh

The generated report mentions *mawh* as disjunction or alternative-question material, but the current checked evidence only has Genesis 6:3, where *mawh* is lexical or analyzer-noise material glossed as *sin* / *V* rather than as disjunction. *Mawh* therefore remains not well-supported in this slice.

Report-only schematic examples such as *mi mawh ganhing mawh* or *pai ding mawh om ding mawh* should not be printed unless a later analyzer-backed row is actually located.

4.4.6 Adversative *Ahih hangin*

Genesis 3:4 supplies the current adversative connector anchor:

- (4.96) *Àhih* *hàng-in*
 be.3SG.REL because-ERG
 ‘but’ (Genesis 3:4)

This row is usable with caveat as the current adversative connector. It remains internally analyzable as *ahih* + *hang-in*, so the present slice should not open a full causal or subordinator analysis from this row.

4.4.7 Conditional-adversative *ahih kei leh*

Exodus 12:3 keeps one compact boundary row visible:

- (4.97) *àhih* *kèi* *lèh*
 be.3SG.REL NEG and
 ‘otherwise’ / ‘if not’ (Exodus 12:3)

This row is useful as conditional-adversative boundary material, but it is not a simple coordinator. It overlaps with negation and conditional *leh*, yet the slice should not reopen the stabilized negation section.

4.4.8 Deferred material

Several limits remain important at this stage:

- clean simple clause-conjunction *leh* remains deferred;
- clean *mawh* disjunction or alternative-question evidence remains deferred;
- full sequential-*a* analysis remains deferred;
- *ciangin* and broader *hangin* temporal or causal subordinator material remain deferred;
- full clause-chaining or converb coordination remains deferred;
- sentence-final particles remain outside the scope of this slice;
- generated-report raw counts remain excluded.

Broad TAM, directionals, chrestomathy, Mizo/lus, and other Kuki-Chin language work likewise remain deferred.

4.4.9 Editorial summary

This slice now safely supports four modest claims: *le* is the current NP conjunction anchor, anchored by *vantung le leitung*; *Ahih hangin* is usable as an adversative connector with caveat; *ahih kei leh* is useful as conditional-adversative boundary evidence with caveat; and *leh*, *a*, plus *mawh* remain visible only as warning, deferred, or boundary material.

What remains deferred is equally important: raw frequency counts, treating every *le*, *leh*, or *a* token as coordinator evidence, simple clause-conjunction *leh*, *mawh* as accepted disjunction, a full sequential-*a* analysis, a fuller temporal or causal subordinator treatment, and sentence-final particles.

4.5 Reduplication

4.5.1 Full reduplication as intensification

mahmah is the main full-reduplication intensifier anchor.

The controlled segmentation and gloss/function are *mah~mah* and *EMPH~EMPH* / *very, truly*.

The report also supports the worked example *pha mahmah hi*, glossed there as *good very DECL*.

taktak is the closest support row for the same small intensifying pattern.

Its controlled segmentation and gloss/function are *tak~tak* and *TRUE~TRUE* / *truly, certainly*.

Taken together, *mahmah* and *taktak* support a narrow full-reduplication intensifier pattern, not the whole reduplication system.

4.5.2 Secondary distributive evidence

peuhpeuh remains visible as secondary distributive evidence for full reduplication.

Its controlled segmentation and gloss/function are *peuh~peuh* and *each~each* / *every, each*.

It stays outside the leading claim because it is more quantifier-like or noun-modifying than the clean intensifier anchors.

4.5.3 Boundary material

ni ni stays outside the first grammar slice because syntactic X X repetition overlaps with temporal/adverbial and VP-structure interpretation.

leuleu stays outside because iterative or continuative reduplication overlaps with TAM/aspect and VP structure.

gengen stays outside because the verbal reduplication evidence is too thin for the first print-facing claim.

kawikawi stays outside because it is expressive, spatial-totality, or lexicalized-looking material.

theithe stays outside because it is report-only and overlaps adverbial, modal, or ability-related territory.

bangbang, *bekbek*, *zenzen*, *tuamtum*, or similar report-only analysis-table rows stay outside because they are not yet controlled enough for the first slice.

analyzer-noisy, count-only, or theory-heavy whole-system claims stay outside because they do not yet produce a safe first print-facing pattern.

Any broad derivation chapter claim stays outside because this section is not yet ready to widen one narrow full-reduplication slice into a full derivational account.

Any dictionary-entry claim stays outside because this section is constructional rather than lexical.

4.5.4 Safe first-slice claim

At the current slice maturity level, the safest reduplication claim is that Tedim has checked evidence for full reduplication used in intensification, with *mahmah* / *mah~mah* as the main anchor and *taktak* / *tak~tak* as the closest support row. Distributive *peuhpeuh* remains visible as secondary evidence, while syntactic, aspectual, verbal, lexicalized-looking, and report-only reduplication rows remain candidate-layer or boundary material.

That claim is deliberately smaller than a full derivation chapter, smaller than a full reduplication chapter, smaller than a TAM/aspect or VP-structure slice, and smaller than a dictionary slice.

4.5.5 Recommended next step

This grammar slice is now paired with background notes, so the section is keeps the analysis deliberately narrow at its current full-reduplication-intensifier slice maturity level.

If more reduplication work is chosen after that checkpoint, the next sub-scope should be distributive *peuhpeuh* or syntactic *ni ni*, not lexicalized-looking or aspect-heavy rows.

4.6 Broader discourse

A fuller treatment of discourse structure is not yet included in this draft.

4.7 Analyzer-gap caution

Several cross-cutting morphological issues remain unresolved and are not yet integrated into this draft.

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